Sample Mortgage Bank Limited

Mortgage Loan Policy

Version 7.0

Item	Detail
Effective date	01-Apr-2026
Supersedes	Version 6.0 (effective 01-Oct-2024)
Total pages	1000
Owner	Retail Credit Policy Department
Classification	Internal. Synthetic document created only for RAG testing - not a real bank policy.

Document Control

Version	Effective date	Supersedes	Status
7.0	01-Apr-2026	6.0	In force from the effective date

Summary of changes from the previous version

The following 8 changes were made compared with version 6.0. All other terms are unchanged.

No.	Parameter	Previous	Revised
1	Minimum credit score	720	725
2	Maximum FOIR	55%	60%
3	Bank Reference Rate (BRR)	8.00%	7.75%
4	Spread over BRR	2.50%	2.35%
5	Valuation fee	Rs 3,500	Rs 4,000
6	Penal charge on overdue EMI	18%	12%
7	Balance-transfer processing fee waiver	50%	100%
8	Green home rate discount	Not mentioned	0.15%

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Part A - Mortgage Loan Policy

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 This Mortgage Loan Policy (the Policy) sets out eligibility, pricing, sanction and servicing norms for mortgage loans offered by Sample Mortgage Bank Limited (the Bank) to individual borrowers. This is Version 7.0, effective 01-Apr-2026.

1.2 Version precedence: where two versions of this Policy differ, the latest effective version prevails for all new applications. An earlier version continues to apply only to loans sanctioned during that version's effective period.

1.3 Products covered by this Policy:

- Home purchase loan
- Home construction loan
- Home improvement loan
- Loan against property (LAP)

2. Eligibility

The Bank assesses every applicant against the criteria below. An application that does not meet a criterion is declined unless an exception is approved in writing under the exception process of this Policy.

2.1 The minimum age of the applicant at the time of application is 23 years. The maximum age of the applicant at loan maturity is 70 years.

2.2 The minimum credit score required is 725. Applications below this score are declined.

2.3 Self-employed applicants must have a minimum business vintage of 2 years.

2.4 Non-Resident Indians (NRI) are eligible. The maximum LTV for NRI applicants is 75% irrespective of loan amount.

Table 1: Eligibility summary

Criterion	Requirement
Minimum age at application	23 years
Maximum age at maturity	70 years
Minimum credit score	725
Self-employed business vintage	At least 2 years
NRI applicants	Eligible, maximum LTV 75%

3. Loan Quantum

3.1 Minimum loan amount: Rs 10 lakh. Maximum loan amount: Rs 5.0 crore per borrower.

3.2 The maximum Loan-to-Value (LTV) ratio depends on the loan amount requested: up to Rs 30 lakh: 80%; above Rs 30 lakh and up to Rs 75 lakh: 75%; above Rs 75 lakh: 70%.

Table 2: Maximum LTV by loan amount

Loan amount requested	Maximum LTV
Up to Rs 30 lakh	80%
Above Rs 30 lakh and up to Rs 75 lakh	75%
Above Rs 75 lakh	70%

3.3 The maximum Fixed Obligation to Income Ratio (FOIR) is 60% of net monthly income. Maximum permissible EMI = FOIR x net monthly income - existing monthly obligations.

4. Tenure

4.1 The maximum loan tenure is 35 years, subject to the maximum age at maturity in clause 2.1.

5. Pricing and Charges

5.1 Floating interest rate = Bank Reference Rate (BRR) + spread. Under this version the BRR is 7.75% per annum and the spread is 2.35% per annum, so the applicable floating rate is 10.10% per annum.

5.2 Processing fee: 0.50% of the sanctioned loan amount, exclusive of taxes.

5.3 Valuation fee: Rs 4,000 per property, non-refundable.

5.4 Penal charge on overdue EMI: 12% per annum on the overdue amount, calculated daily on a 365-day year.

5.5 Prepayment / foreclosure charge on floating rate loans to individual borrowers: Nil.

Table 3: Summary of charges

Charge	Rate / amount	Basis
Interest rate (floating)	10.10% p.a.	BRR + spread
Processing fee	0.50%	Sanctioned loan amount, excl. taxes
Valuation fee	Rs 4,000	Per property
Penal charge on overdue EMI	12% p.a.	Overdue amount, daily, 365-day year
Prepayment charge (floating)	Nil	Principal amount prepaid

6. Security and Insurance

6.1 Mortgage of the financed property is mandatory. Property (fire and allied perils) insurance is mandatory. Life insurance cover for the primary borrower is optional.

7. Sanction and Disbursement

7.1 A sanction letter is valid for 180 days from the date of issue. If the loan is not disbursed within the validity period the sanction lapses.

8. Special Features

8.1 Top-up loan: existing borrowers with a satisfactory repayment track record may avail a top-up of up to 60% of the outstanding principal.

8.2 Balance transfer: a waiver of 100% of the processing fee is offered for take-over of loans from other lenders.

8.3 Green home discount: a reduction of 0.15% per annum in the interest rate is offered for properties with a recognised green building certification.

9. Sanctioning Authority

9.1 Branches are graded A, B and C. Maximum loan a branch may sanction: Grade A - Rs 300 lakh; Grade B - Rs 150 lakh; Grade C - Rs 75 lakh. Loans above the branch limit must be referred to the Regional Credit Committee.

Table 4: Branch sanction limits

Branch grade	Maximum loan the branch may sanction
Grade A	Rs 300 lakh
Grade B	Rs 150 lakh
Grade C	Rs 75 lakh

10. Annexures

10.1 Annexure A (Branch Master) and Annexure B (Document Retention Register) are placed at the end of this document.

Part B - Operating Guidelines

Part B sets out the operating procedures that support the Policy in Part A. Each chapter deals with one function and is divided into five sections: objective, roles, procedure, exceptions and records.

Chapter 11: Credit appraisal (Part 1)

11.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 11. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

11.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 11.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

11.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 11.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

11.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

11.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 11.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 11.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 12: Income assessment (Part 1)

12.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 12. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

12.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 12.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

12.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 12.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

12.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

12.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 12.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 12.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 13: Property valuation (Part 1)

13.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 13. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

13.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 13.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

13.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 13.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

13.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

13.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 13.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 13.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 14: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 1)

14.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 14. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

14.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 14.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

14.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 14.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

14.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

14.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 14.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 14.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 15: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 1)

15.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 15. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

15.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 15.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

15.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 15.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

15.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

15.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 15.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 15.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 16: Loan documentation (Part 1)

16.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 16. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

16.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 16.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

16.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 16.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

16.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

16.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 16.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 16.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 17: Disbursement conditions (Part 1)

17.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 17. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

17.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 17.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

17.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 17.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

17.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

17.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 17.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 17.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 18: Collections and recovery (Part 1)

18.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 18. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

18.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 18.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

18.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 18.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

18.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

18.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 18.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 18.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 19: Customer grievance handling (Part 1)

19.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 19. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

19.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 19.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

19.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 19.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

19.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

19.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 19.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 19.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 20: Internal audit and compliance (Part 1)

20.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 20. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

20.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 20.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

20.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 20.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

20.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

20.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 20.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 20.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 21: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 1)

21.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 21. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

21.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 21.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

21.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 21.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

21.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

21.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 21.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 21.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 22: Fraud monitoring (Part 1)

22.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 22. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

22.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 22.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

22.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 22.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

22.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

22.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 22.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 22.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 23: Customer communication (Part 1)

23.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 23. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

23.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 23.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

23.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 23.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

23.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

23.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 23.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 23.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 24: Staff training and certification (Part 1)

24.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 24. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

24.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 24.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

24.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 24.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

24.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

24.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 24.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 24.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 25: Credit appraisal (Part 2)

25.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 25. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

25.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 25.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

25.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 25.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

25.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

25.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 25.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 25.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 26: Income assessment (Part 2)

26.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 26. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

26.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 26.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

26.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 26.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

26.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

26.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 26.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 26.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 27: Property valuation (Part 2)

27.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 27. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

27.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 27.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

27.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 27.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

27.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

27.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 27.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 27.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 28: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 2)

28.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 28. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

28.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 28.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

28.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 28.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

28.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

28.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 28.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 28.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 29: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 2)

29.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 29. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

29.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 29.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

29.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 29.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

29.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

29.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 29.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 29.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 30: Loan documentation (Part 2)

30.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 30. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

30.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 30.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

30.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 30.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

30.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

30.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 30.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 30.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 31: Disbursement conditions (Part 2)

31.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 31. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

31.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 31.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

31.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 31.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

31.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

31.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 31.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 31.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 32: Collections and recovery (Part 2)

32.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 32. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

32.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 32.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

32.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 32.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

32.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

32.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 32.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 32.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 33: Customer grievance handling (Part 2)

33.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 33. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

33.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 33.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

33.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 33.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

33.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

33.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 33.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 33.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 34: Internal audit and compliance (Part 2)

34.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 34. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

34.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 34.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

34.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 34.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

34.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

34.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 34.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 34.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 35: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 2)

35.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 35. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

35.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 35.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

35.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 35.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

35.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

35.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 35.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 35.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 36: Fraud monitoring (Part 2)

36.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 36. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

36.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 36.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

36.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 36.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

36.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

36.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 36.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 36.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 37: Customer communication (Part 2)

37.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 37. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

37.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 37.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

37.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 37.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

37.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

37.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 37.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 37.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 38: Staff training and certification (Part 2)

38.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 38. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

38.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 38.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

38.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 38.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

38.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

38.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 38.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 38.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 39: Credit appraisal (Part 3)

39.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 39. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

39.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 39.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

39.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 39.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

39.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

39.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 39.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 39.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 40: Income assessment (Part 3)

40.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 40. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

40.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 40.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

40.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 40.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

40.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

40.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 40.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 40.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 41: Property valuation (Part 3)

41.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 41. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

41.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 41.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

41.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 41.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

41.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

41.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 41.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 41.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 42: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 3)

42.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 42. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

42.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 42.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

42.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 42.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

42.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

42.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 42.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 42.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 43: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 3)

43.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 43. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

43.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 43.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

43.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 43.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

43.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

43.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 43.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 43.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 44: Loan documentation (Part 3)

44.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 44. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

44.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 44.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

44.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 44.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

44.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

44.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 44.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 44.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 45: Disbursement conditions (Part 3)

45.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 45. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

45.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 45.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

45.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 45.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

45.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

45.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 45.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 45.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 46: Collections and recovery (Part 3)

46.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 46. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

46.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 46.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

46.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 46.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

46.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

46.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 46.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 46.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 47: Customer grievance handling (Part 3)

47.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 47. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

47.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 47.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

47.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 47.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

47.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

47.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 47.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 47.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 48: Internal audit and compliance (Part 3)

48.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 48. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

48.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 48.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

48.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 48.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

48.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

48.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 48.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 48.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 49: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 3)

49.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 49. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

49.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 49.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

49.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 49.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

49.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

49.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 49.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 49.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 50: Fraud monitoring (Part 3)

50.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 50. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

50.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 50.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

50.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 50.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

50.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

50.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 50.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 50.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 51: Customer communication (Part 3)

51.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 51. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

51.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 51.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

51.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 51.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

51.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

51.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 51.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 51.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 52: Staff training and certification (Part 3)

52.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 52. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

52.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 52.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

52.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 52.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

52.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

52.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 52.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 52.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 53: Credit appraisal (Part 4)

53.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 53. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

53.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 53.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

53.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 53.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

53.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

53.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 53.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 53.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 54: Income assessment (Part 4)

54.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 54. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

54.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 54.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

54.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 54.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

54.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

54.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 54.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 54.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 55: Property valuation (Part 4)

55.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 55. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

55.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 55.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

55.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 55.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

55.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

55.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 55.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 55.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 56: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 4)

56.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 56. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

56.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 56.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

56.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 56.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

56.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

56.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 56.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 56.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 57: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 4)

57.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 57. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

57.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 57.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

57.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 57.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

57.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

57.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 57.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 57.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 58: Loan documentation (Part 4)

58.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 58. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

58.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 58.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

58.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 58.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

58.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

58.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 58.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 58.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 59: Disbursement conditions (Part 4)

59.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 59. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

59.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 59.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

59.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 59.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

59.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

59.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 59.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 59.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 60: Collections and recovery (Part 4)

60.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 60. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

60.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 60.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

60.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 60.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

60.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

60.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 60.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 60.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 61: Customer grievance handling (Part 4)

61.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 61. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

61.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 61.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

61.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 61.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

61.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

61.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 61.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 61.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 62: Internal audit and compliance (Part 4)

62.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 62. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

62.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 62.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

62.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 62.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

62.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

62.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 62.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 62.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 63: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 4)

63.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 63. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

63.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 63.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

63.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 63.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

63.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

63.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 63.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 63.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 64: Fraud monitoring (Part 4)

64.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 64. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

64.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 64.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

64.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 64.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

64.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

64.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 64.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 64.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 65: Customer communication (Part 4)

65.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 65. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

65.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 65.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

65.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 65.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

65.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

65.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 65.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 65.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 66: Staff training and certification (Part 4)

66.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 66. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

66.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 66.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

66.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 66.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

66.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

66.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 66.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 66.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 67: Credit appraisal (Part 5)

67.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 67. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

67.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 67.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

67.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 67.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

67.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

67.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 67.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 67.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 68: Income assessment (Part 5)

68.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 68. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

68.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 68.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

68.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 68.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

68.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

68.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 68.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 68.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 69: Property valuation (Part 5)

69.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 69. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

69.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 69.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

69.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 69.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

69.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

69.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 69.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 69.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 70: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 5)

70.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 70. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

70.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 70.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

70.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 70.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

70.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

70.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 70.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 70.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 71: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 5)

71.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 71. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

71.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 71.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

71.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 71.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

71.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

71.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 71.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 71.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 72: Loan documentation (Part 5)

72.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 72. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

72.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 72.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

72.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 72.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

72.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

72.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 72.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 72.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 73: Disbursement conditions (Part 5)

73.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 73. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

73.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 73.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

73.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 73.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

73.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

73.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 73.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 73.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 74: Collections and recovery (Part 5)

74.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 74. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

74.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 74.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

74.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 74.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

74.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

74.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 74.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 74.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 75: Customer grievance handling (Part 5)

75.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 75. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

75.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 75.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

75.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 75.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

75.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

75.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 75.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 75.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 76: Internal audit and compliance (Part 5)

76.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 76. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

76.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 76.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

76.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 76.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

76.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

76.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 76.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 76.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 77: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 5)

77.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 77. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

77.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 77.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

77.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 77.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

77.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

77.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 77.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 77.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 78: Fraud monitoring (Part 5)

78.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 78. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

78.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 78.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

78.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 78.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

78.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

78.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 78.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 78.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 79: Customer communication (Part 5)

79.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 79. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

79.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 79.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

79.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 79.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

79.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

79.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 79.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 79.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 80: Staff training and certification (Part 5)

80.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 80. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

80.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 80.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

80.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 80.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

80.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

80.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 80.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 80.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 81: Credit appraisal (Part 6)

81.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 81. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

81.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 81.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

81.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 81.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

81.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

81.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 81.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 81.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 82: Income assessment (Part 6)

82.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 82. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

82.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 82.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

82.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 82.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

82.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

82.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 82.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 82.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 83: Property valuation (Part 6)

83.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 83. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

83.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 83.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

83.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 83.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

83.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

83.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 83.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 83.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 84: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 6)

84.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 84. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

84.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 84.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

84.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 84.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

84.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

84.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 84.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 84.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 85: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 6)

85.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 85. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

85.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 85.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

85.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 85.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

85.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

85.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 85.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 85.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 86: Loan documentation (Part 6)

86.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 86. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

86.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 86.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

86.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 86.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

86.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

86.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 86.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 86.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 87: Disbursement conditions (Part 6)

87.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 87. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

87.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 87.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

87.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 87.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

87.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

87.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 87.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 87.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 88: Collections and recovery (Part 6)

88.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 88. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

88.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 88.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

88.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 88.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

88.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

88.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 88.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 88.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 89: Customer grievance handling (Part 6)

89.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 89. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

89.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 89.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

89.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 89.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

89.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

89.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 89.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 89.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 90: Internal audit and compliance (Part 6)

90.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 90. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

90.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 90.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

90.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 90.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

90.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

90.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 90.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 90.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 91: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 6)

91.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 91. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

91.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 91.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

91.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 91.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

91.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

91.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 91.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 91.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 92: Fraud monitoring (Part 6)

92.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 92. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

92.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 92.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

92.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 92.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

92.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

92.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 92.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 92.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 93: Customer communication (Part 6)

93.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 93. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

93.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 93.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

93.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 93.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

93.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

93.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 93.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 93.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 94: Staff training and certification (Part 6)

94.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 94. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

94.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 94.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

94.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 94.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

94.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

94.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 94.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 94.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 95: Credit appraisal (Part 7)

95.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 95. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

95.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 95.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

95.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 95.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

95.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

95.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 95.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 95.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 96: Income assessment (Part 7)

96.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 96. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

96.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 96.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

96.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 96.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

96.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

96.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 96.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 96.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 97: Property valuation (Part 7)

97.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 97. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

97.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 97.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

97.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 97.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

97.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

97.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 97.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 97.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 98: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 7)

98.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 98. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

98.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 98.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

98.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 98.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

98.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

98.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 98.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 98.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 99: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 7)

99.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 99. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

99.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 99.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

99.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 99.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

99.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

99.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 99.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 99.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 100: Loan documentation (Part 7)

100.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 100. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

100.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 100.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

100.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 100.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

100.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

100.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 100.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 100.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 101: Disbursement conditions (Part 7)

101.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 101. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

101.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 101.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

101.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 101.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

101.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

101.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 101.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 101.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 102: Collections and recovery (Part 7)

102.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 102. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

102.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 102.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

102.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 102.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

102.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

102.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 102.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 102.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 103: Customer grievance handling (Part 7)

103.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 103. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

103.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 103.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

103.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 103.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

103.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

103.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 103.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 103.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 104: Internal audit and compliance (Part 7)

104.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 104. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

104.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 104.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

104.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 104.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

104.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

104.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 104.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 104.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 105: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 7)

105.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 105. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

105.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 105.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

105.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 105.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

105.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

105.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 105.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 105.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 106: Fraud monitoring (Part 7)

106.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 106. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

106.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 106.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

106.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 106.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

106.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

106.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 106.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 106.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 107: Customer communication (Part 7)

107.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 107. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

107.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 107.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

107.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 107.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

107.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

107.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 107.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 107.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 108: Staff training and certification (Part 7)

108.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 108. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

108.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 108.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

108.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 108.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

108.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

108.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 108.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 108.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 109: Credit appraisal (Part 8)

109.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 109. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

109.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 109.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

109.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 109.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

109.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

109.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 109.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 109.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 110: Income assessment (Part 8)

110.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 110. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

110.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 110.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

110.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 110.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

110.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

110.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 110.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 110.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 111: Property valuation (Part 8)

111.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 111. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

111.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 111.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

111.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 111.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

111.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

111.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 111.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 111.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 112: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 8)

112.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 112. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

112.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 112.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

112.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 112.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

112.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

112.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 112.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 112.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 113: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 8)

113.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 113. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

113.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 113.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

113.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 113.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

113.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

113.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 113.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 113.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 114: Loan documentation (Part 8)

114.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 114. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

114.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 114.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

114.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 114.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

114.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

114.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 114.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 114.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 115: Disbursement conditions (Part 8)

115.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 115. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

115.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 115.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

115.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 115.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

115.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

115.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 115.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 115.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 116: Collections and recovery (Part 8)

116.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 116. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

116.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 116.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

116.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 116.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

116.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

116.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 116.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 116.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 117: Customer grievance handling (Part 8)

117.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 117. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

117.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 117.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

117.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 117.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

117.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

117.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 117.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 117.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 118: Internal audit and compliance (Part 8)

118.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 118. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

118.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 118.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

118.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 118.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

118.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

118.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 118.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 118.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 119: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 8)

119.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 119. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

119.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 119.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

119.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 119.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

119.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

119.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 119.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 119.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 120: Fraud monitoring (Part 8)

120.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 120. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

120.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 120.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

120.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 120.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

120.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

120.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 120.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 120.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 121: Customer communication (Part 8)

121.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 121. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

121.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 121.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

121.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 121.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

121.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

121.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 121.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 121.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 122: Staff training and certification (Part 8)

122.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 122. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

122.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 122.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

122.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 122.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

122.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

122.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 122.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 122.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 123: Credit appraisal (Part 9)

123.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 123. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

123.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 123.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

123.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 123.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

123.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

123.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 123.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 123.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 124: Income assessment (Part 9)

124.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 124. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

124.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 124.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

124.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 124.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

124.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

124.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 124.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 124.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 125: Property valuation (Part 9)

125.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 125. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

125.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 125.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

125.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 125.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

125.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

125.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 125.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 125.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 126: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 9)

126.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 126. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

126.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 126.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

126.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 126.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

126.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

126.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 126.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 126.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 127: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 9)

127.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 127. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

127.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 127.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

127.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 127.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

127.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

127.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 127.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 127.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 128: Loan documentation (Part 9)

128.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 128. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

128.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 128.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

128.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 128.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

128.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

128.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 128.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 128.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 129: Disbursement conditions (Part 9)

129.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 129. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

129.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 129.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

129.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 129.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

129.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

129.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 129.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 129.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 130: Collections and recovery (Part 9)

130.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 130. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

130.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 130.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

130.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 130.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

130.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

130.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 130.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 130.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 131: Customer grievance handling (Part 9)

131.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 131. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

131.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 131.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

131.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 131.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

131.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

131.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 131.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 131.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 132: Internal audit and compliance (Part 9)

132.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 132. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

132.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 132.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

132.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 132.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

132.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

132.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 132.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 132.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 133: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 9)

133.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 133. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

133.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 133.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

133.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 133.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

133.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

133.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 133.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 133.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 134: Fraud monitoring (Part 9)

134.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 134. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

134.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 134.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

134.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 134.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

134.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

134.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 134.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 134.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 135: Customer communication (Part 9)

135.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 135. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

135.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 135.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

135.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 135.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

135.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

135.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 135.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 135.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 136: Staff training and certification (Part 9)

136.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 136. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

136.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 136.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

136.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 136.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

136.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

136.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 136.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 136.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 137: Credit appraisal (Part 10)

137.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 137. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

137.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 137.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

137.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 137.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

137.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

137.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 137.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 137.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 138: Income assessment (Part 10)

138.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 138. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

138.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 138.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

138.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 138.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

138.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

138.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 138.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 138.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 139: Property valuation (Part 10)

139.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 139. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

139.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 139.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

139.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 139.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

139.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

139.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 139.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 139.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 140: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 10)

140.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 140. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

140.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 140.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

140.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 140.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

140.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

140.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 140.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 140.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 141: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 10)

141.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 141. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

141.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 141.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

141.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 141.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

141.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

141.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 141.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 141.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 142: Loan documentation (Part 10)

142.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 142. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

142.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 142.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

142.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 142.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

142.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

142.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 142.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 142.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 143: Disbursement conditions (Part 10)

143.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 143. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

143.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 143.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

143.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 143.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

143.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

143.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 143.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 143.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 144: Collections and recovery (Part 10)

144.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 144. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

144.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 144.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

144.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 144.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

144.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

144.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 144.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 144.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 145: Customer grievance handling (Part 10)

145.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 145. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

145.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 145.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

145.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 145.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

145.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

145.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 145.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 145.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 146: Internal audit and compliance (Part 10)

146.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 146. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

146.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 146.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

146.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 146.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

146.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

146.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 146.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 146.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 147: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 10)

147.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 147. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

147.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 147.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

147.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 147.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

147.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

147.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 147.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 147.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 148: Fraud monitoring (Part 10)

148.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 148. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

148.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 148.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

148.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 148.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

148.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

148.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 148.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 148.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 149: Customer communication (Part 10)

149.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 149. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

149.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 149.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

149.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 149.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

149.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

149.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 149.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 149.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 150: Staff training and certification (Part 10)

150.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 150. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

150.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 150.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

150.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 150.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

150.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

150.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 150.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 150.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 151: Credit appraisal (Part 11)

151.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 151. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

151.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 151.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

151.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 151.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

151.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

151.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 151.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 151.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 152: Income assessment (Part 11)

152.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 152. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

152.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 152.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

152.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 152.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

152.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

152.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 152.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 152.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 153: Property valuation (Part 11)

153.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 153. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

153.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 153.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

153.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 153.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

153.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

153.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 153.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 153.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 154: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 11)

154.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 154. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

154.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 154.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

154.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 154.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

154.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

154.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 154.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 154.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 155: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 11)

155.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 155. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

155.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 155.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

155.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 155.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

155.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

155.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 155.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 155.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 156: Loan documentation (Part 11)

156.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 156. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

156.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 156.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

156.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 156.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

156.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

156.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 156.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 156.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 157: Disbursement conditions (Part 11)

157.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 157. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

157.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 157.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

157.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 157.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

157.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

157.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 157.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 157.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 158: Collections and recovery (Part 11)

158.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 158. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

158.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 158.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

158.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 158.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

158.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

158.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 158.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 158.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 159: Customer grievance handling (Part 11)

159.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 159. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

159.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 159.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

159.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 159.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

159.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

159.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 159.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 159.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 160: Internal audit and compliance (Part 11)

160.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 160. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

160.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 160.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

160.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 160.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

160.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

160.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 160.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 160.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 161: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 11)

161.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 161. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

161.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 161.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

161.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 161.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

161.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

161.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 161.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 161.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 162: Fraud monitoring (Part 11)

162.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 162. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

162.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 162.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

162.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 162.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

162.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

162.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 162.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 162.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 163: Customer communication (Part 11)

163.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 163. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

163.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 163.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

163.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 163.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

163.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

163.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 163.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 163.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 164: Staff training and certification (Part 11)

164.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 164. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

164.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 164.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

164.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 164.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

164.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

164.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 164.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 164.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 165: Credit appraisal (Part 12)

165.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 165. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

165.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 165.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

165.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 165.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

165.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

165.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 165.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 165.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 166: Income assessment (Part 12)

166.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 166. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

166.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 166.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

166.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 166.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

166.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

166.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 166.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 166.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 167: Property valuation (Part 12)

167.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 167. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

167.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 167.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

167.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 167.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

167.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

167.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 167.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 167.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 168: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 12)

168.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 168. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

168.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 168.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

168.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 168.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

168.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

168.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 168.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 168.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 169: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 12)

169.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 169. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

169.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 169.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

169.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 169.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

169.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

169.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 169.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 169.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 170: Loan documentation (Part 12)

170.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 170. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

170.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 170.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

170.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 170.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

170.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

170.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 170.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 170.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 171: Disbursement conditions (Part 12)

171.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 171. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

171.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 171.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

171.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 171.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

171.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

171.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 171.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 171.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 172: Collections and recovery (Part 12)

172.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 172. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

172.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 172.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

172.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 172.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

172.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

172.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 172.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 172.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 173: Customer grievance handling (Part 12)

173.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 173. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

173.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 173.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

173.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 173.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

173.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

173.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 173.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 173.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 174: Internal audit and compliance (Part 12)

174.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 174. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

174.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 174.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

174.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 174.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

174.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

174.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 174.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 174.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 175: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 12)

175.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 175. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

175.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 175.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

175.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 175.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

175.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

175.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 175.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 175.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 176: Fraud monitoring (Part 12)

176.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 176. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

176.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 176.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

176.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 176.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

176.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

176.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 176.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 176.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 177: Customer communication (Part 12)

177.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 177. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

177.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 177.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

177.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 177.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

177.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

177.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 177.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 177.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 178: Staff training and certification (Part 12)

178.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 178. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

178.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 178.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

178.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 178.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

178.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

178.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 178.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 178.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 179: Credit appraisal (Part 13)

179.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 179. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

179.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 179.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

179.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 179.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

179.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

179.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 179.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 179.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 180: Income assessment (Part 13)

180.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 180. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

180.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 180.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

180.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 180.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

180.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

180.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 180.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 180.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 181: Property valuation (Part 13)

181.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 181. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

181.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 181.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

181.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 181.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

181.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

181.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 181.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 181.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 182: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 13)

182.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 182. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

182.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 182.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

182.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 182.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

182.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

182.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 182.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 182.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 183: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 13)

183.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 183. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

183.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 183.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

183.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 183.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

183.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

183.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 183.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 183.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 184: Loan documentation (Part 13)

184.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 184. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

184.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 184.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

184.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 184.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

184.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

184.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 184.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 184.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 185: Disbursement conditions (Part 13)

185.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 185. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

185.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 185.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

185.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 185.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

185.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

185.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 185.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 185.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 186: Collections and recovery (Part 13)

186.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 186. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

186.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 186.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

186.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 186.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

186.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

186.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 186.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 186.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 187: Customer grievance handling (Part 13)

187.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 187. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

187.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 187.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

187.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 187.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

187.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

187.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 187.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 187.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 188: Internal audit and compliance (Part 13)

188.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 188. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

188.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 188.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

188.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 188.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

188.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

188.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 188.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 188.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 189: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 13)

189.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 189. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

189.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 189.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

189.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 189.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

189.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

189.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 189.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 189.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 190: Fraud monitoring (Part 13)

190.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 190. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

190.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 190.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

190.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 190.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

190.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

190.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 190.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 190.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 191: Customer communication (Part 13)

191.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 191. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

191.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 191.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

191.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 191.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

191.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

191.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 191.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 191.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 192: Staff training and certification (Part 13)

192.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 192. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

192.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 192.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

192.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 192.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

192.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

192.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 192.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 192.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 193: Credit appraisal (Part 14)

193.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 193. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

193.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 193.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

193.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 193.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

193.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

193.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 193.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 193.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 194: Income assessment (Part 14)

194.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 194. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

194.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 194.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

194.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 194.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

194.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

194.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 194.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 194.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 195: Property valuation (Part 14)

195.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 195. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

195.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 195.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

195.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 195.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

195.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

195.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 195.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 195.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 196: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 14)

196.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 196. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

196.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 196.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

196.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 196.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

196.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

196.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 196.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 196.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 197: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 14)

197.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 197. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

197.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 197.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

197.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 197.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

197.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

197.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 197.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 197.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 198: Loan documentation (Part 14)

198.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 198. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

198.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 198.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

198.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 198.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

198.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

198.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 198.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 198.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 199: Disbursement conditions (Part 14)

199.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 199. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

199.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 199.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

199.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 199.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

199.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

199.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 199.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 199.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 200: Collections and recovery (Part 14)

200.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 200. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

200.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 200.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

200.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 200.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

200.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

200.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 200.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 200.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 201: Customer grievance handling (Part 14)

201.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 201. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

201.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 201.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

201.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 201.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

201.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

201.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 201.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 201.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 202: Internal audit and compliance (Part 14)

202.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 202. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

202.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 202.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

202.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 202.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

202.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

202.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 202.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 202.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 203: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 14)

203.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 203. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

203.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 203.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

203.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 203.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

203.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

203.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 203.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 203.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 204: Fraud monitoring (Part 14)

204.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 204. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

204.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 204.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

204.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 204.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

204.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

204.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 204.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 204.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 205: Customer communication (Part 14)

205.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 205. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

205.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 205.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

205.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 205.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

205.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

205.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 205.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 205.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 206: Staff training and certification (Part 14)

206.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 206. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

206.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 206.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

206.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 206.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

206.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

206.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 206.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 206.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 207: Credit appraisal (Part 15)

207.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 207. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

207.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 207.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

207.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 207.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

207.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

207.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 207.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 207.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 208: Income assessment (Part 15)

208.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 208. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

208.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 208.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

208.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 208.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

208.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

208.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 208.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 208.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 209: Property valuation (Part 15)

209.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 209. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

209.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 209.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

209.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 209.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

209.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

209.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 209.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 209.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 210: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 15)

210.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 210. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

210.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 210.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

210.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 210.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

210.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

210.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 210.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 210.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 211: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 15)

211.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 211. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

211.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 211.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

211.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 211.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

211.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

211.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 211.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 211.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 212: Loan documentation (Part 15)

212.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 212. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

212.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 212.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

212.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 212.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

212.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

212.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 212.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 212.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 213: Disbursement conditions (Part 15)

213.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 213. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

213.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 213.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

213.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 213.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

213.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

213.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 213.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 213.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 214: Collections and recovery (Part 15)

214.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 214. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

214.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 214.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

214.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 214.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

214.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

214.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 214.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 214.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 215: Customer grievance handling (Part 15)

215.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 215. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

215.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 215.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

215.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 215.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

215.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

215.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 215.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 215.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 216: Internal audit and compliance (Part 15)

216.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 216. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

216.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 216.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

216.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 216.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

216.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

216.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 216.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 216.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 217: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 15)

217.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 217. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

217.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 217.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

217.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 217.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

217.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

217.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 217.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 217.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 218: Fraud monitoring (Part 15)

218.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 218. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

218.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 218.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

218.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 218.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

218.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

218.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 218.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 218.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 219: Customer communication (Part 15)

219.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 219. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

219.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 219.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

219.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 219.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

219.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

219.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 219.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 219.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 220: Staff training and certification (Part 15)

220.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 220. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

220.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 220.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

220.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 220.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

220.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

220.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 220.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 220.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 221: Credit appraisal (Part 16)

221.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 221. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

221.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 221.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

221.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 221.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

221.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

221.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 221.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 221.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 222: Income assessment (Part 16)

222.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 222. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

222.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 222.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

222.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 222.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

222.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

222.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 222.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 222.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 223: Property valuation (Part 16)

223.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 223. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

223.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 223.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

223.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 223.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

223.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

223.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 223.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 223.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 224: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 16)

224.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 224. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

224.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 224.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

224.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 224.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

224.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

224.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 224.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 224.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 225: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 16)

225.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 225. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

225.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 225.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

225.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 225.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

225.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

225.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 225.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 225.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 226: Loan documentation (Part 16)

226.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 226. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

226.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 226.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

226.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 226.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

226.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

226.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 226.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 226.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 227: Disbursement conditions (Part 16)

227.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 227. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

227.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 227.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

227.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 227.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

227.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

227.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 227.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 227.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 228: Collections and recovery (Part 16)

228.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 228. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

228.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 228.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

228.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 228.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

228.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

228.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 228.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 228.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 229: Customer grievance handling (Part 16)

229.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 229. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

229.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 229.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

229.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 229.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

229.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

229.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 229.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 229.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 230: Internal audit and compliance (Part 16)

230.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 230. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

230.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 230.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

230.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 230.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

230.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

230.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 230.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 230.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 231: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 16)

231.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 231. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

231.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 231.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

231.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 231.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

231.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

231.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 231.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 231.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 232: Fraud monitoring (Part 16)

232.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 232. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

232.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 232.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

232.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 232.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

232.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

232.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 232.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 232.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 233: Customer communication (Part 16)

233.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 233. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

233.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 233.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

233.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 233.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

233.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

233.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 233.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 233.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 234: Staff training and certification (Part 16)

234.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 234. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

234.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 234.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

234.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 234.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

234.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

234.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 234.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 234.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 235: Credit appraisal (Part 17)

235.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 235. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

235.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 235.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

235.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 235.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

235.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

235.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 235.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 235.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 236: Income assessment (Part 17)

236.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 236. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

236.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 236.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

236.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 236.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

236.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

236.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 236.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 236.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 237: Property valuation (Part 17)

237.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 237. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

237.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 237.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

237.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 237.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

237.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

237.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 237.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 237.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 238: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 17)

238.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 238. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

238.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 238.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

238.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 238.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

238.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

238.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 238.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 238.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 239: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 17)

239.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 239. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

239.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 239.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

239.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 239.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

239.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

239.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 239.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 239.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 240: Loan documentation (Part 17)

240.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 240. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

240.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 240.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

240.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 240.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

240.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

240.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 240.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 240.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 241: Disbursement conditions (Part 17)

241.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 241. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

241.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 241.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

241.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 241.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

241.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

241.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 241.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 241.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 242: Collections and recovery (Part 17)

242.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 242. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

242.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 242.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

242.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 242.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

242.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

242.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 242.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 242.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 243: Customer grievance handling (Part 17)

243.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 243. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

243.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 243.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

243.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 243.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

243.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

243.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 243.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 243.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 244: Internal audit and compliance (Part 17)

244.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 244. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

244.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 244.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

244.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 244.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

244.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

244.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 244.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 244.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 245: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 17)

245.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 245. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

245.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 245.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

245.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 245.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

245.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

245.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 245.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 245.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 246: Fraud monitoring (Part 17)

246.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 246. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

246.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 246.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

246.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 246.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

246.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

246.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 246.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 246.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 247: Customer communication (Part 17)

247.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 247. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

247.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 247.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

247.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 247.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

247.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

247.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 247.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 247.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 248: Staff training and certification (Part 17)

248.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 248. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

248.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 248.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

248.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 248.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

248.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

248.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 248.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 248.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 249: Credit appraisal (Part 18)

249.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 249. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

249.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 249.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

249.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 249.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

249.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

249.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 249.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 249.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 250: Income assessment (Part 18)

250.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 250. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

250.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 250.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

250.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 250.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

250.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

250.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 250.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 250.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 251: Property valuation (Part 18)

251.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 251. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

251.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 251.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

251.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 251.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

251.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

251.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 251.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 251.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 252: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 18)

252.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 252. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

252.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 252.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

252.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 252.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

252.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

252.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 252.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 252.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 253: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 18)

253.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 253. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

253.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 253.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

253.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 253.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

253.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

253.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 253.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 253.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 254: Loan documentation (Part 18)

254.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 254. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

254.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 254.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

254.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 254.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

254.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

254.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 254.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 254.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 255: Disbursement conditions (Part 18)

255.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 255. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

255.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 255.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

255.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 255.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

255.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

255.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 255.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 255.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 256: Collections and recovery (Part 18)

256.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 256. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

256.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 256.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

256.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 256.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

256.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

256.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 256.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 256.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 257: Customer grievance handling (Part 18)

257.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 257. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

257.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 257.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

257.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 257.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

257.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

257.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 257.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 257.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 258: Internal audit and compliance (Part 18)

258.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 258. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

258.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 258.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

258.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 258.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

258.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

258.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 258.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 258.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 259: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 18)

259.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 259. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

259.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 259.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

259.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 259.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

259.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

259.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 259.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 259.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 260: Fraud monitoring (Part 18)

260.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 260. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

260.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 260.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

260.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 260.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

260.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

260.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 260.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 260.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 261: Customer communication (Part 18)

261.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 261. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

261.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 261.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

261.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 261.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

261.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

261.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 261.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 261.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 262: Staff training and certification (Part 18)

262.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 262. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

262.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 262.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

262.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 262.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

262.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

262.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 262.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 262.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 263: Credit appraisal (Part 19)

263.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 263. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

263.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 263.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

263.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 263.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

263.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

263.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 263.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 263.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 264: Income assessment (Part 19)

264.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 264. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

264.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 264.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

264.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 264.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

264.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

264.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 264.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 264.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 265: Property valuation (Part 19)

265.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 265. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

265.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 265.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

265.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 265.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

265.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

265.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 265.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 265.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 266: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 19)

266.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 266. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

266.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 266.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

266.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 266.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

266.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

266.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 266.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 266.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 267: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 19)

267.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 267. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

267.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 267.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

267.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 267.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

267.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

267.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 267.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 267.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 268: Loan documentation (Part 19)

268.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 268. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

268.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 268.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

268.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 268.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

268.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

268.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 268.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 268.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 269: Disbursement conditions (Part 19)

269.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 269. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

269.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 269.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

269.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 269.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

269.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

269.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 269.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 269.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 270: Collections and recovery (Part 19)

270.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 270. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

270.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 270.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

270.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 270.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

270.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

270.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 270.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 270.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 271: Customer grievance handling (Part 19)

271.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 271. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

271.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 271.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

271.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 271.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

271.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

271.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 271.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 271.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 272: Internal audit and compliance (Part 19)

272.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 272. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

272.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 272.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

272.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 272.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

272.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

272.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 272.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 272.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 273: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 19)

273.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 273. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

273.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 273.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

273.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 273.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

273.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

273.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 273.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 273.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 274: Fraud monitoring (Part 19)

274.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 274. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

274.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 274.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

274.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 274.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

274.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

274.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 274.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 274.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 275: Customer communication (Part 19)

275.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 275. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

275.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 275.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

275.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 275.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

275.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

275.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 275.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 275.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 276: Staff training and certification (Part 19)

276.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 276. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

276.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 276.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

276.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 276.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

276.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

276.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 276.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 276.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 277: Credit appraisal (Part 20)

277.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 277. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

277.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 277.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

277.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 277.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

277.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

277.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 277.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 277.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 278: Income assessment (Part 20)

278.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 278. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

278.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 278.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

278.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 278.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

278.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

278.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 278.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 278.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 279: Property valuation (Part 20)

279.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 279. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

279.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 279.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

279.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 279.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

279.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

279.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 279.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 279.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 280: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 20)

280.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 280. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

280.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 280.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

280.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 280.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

280.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

280.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 280.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 280.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 281: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 20)

281.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 281. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

281.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 281.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

281.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 281.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

281.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

281.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 281.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 281.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 282: Loan documentation (Part 20)

282.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 282. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

282.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 282.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

282.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 282.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

282.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

282.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 282.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 282.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 283: Disbursement conditions (Part 20)

283.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 283. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

283.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 283.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

283.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 283.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

283.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

283.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 283.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 283.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 284: Collections and recovery (Part 20)

284.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 284. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

284.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 284.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

284.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 284.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

284.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

284.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 284.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 284.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 285: Customer grievance handling (Part 20)

285.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 285. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

285.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 285.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

285.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 285.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

285.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

285.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 285.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 285.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 286: Internal audit and compliance (Part 20)

286.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 286. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

286.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 286.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

286.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 286.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

286.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

286.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 286.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 286.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 287: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 20)

287.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 287. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

287.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 287.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

287.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 287.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

287.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

287.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 287.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 287.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 288: Fraud monitoring (Part 20)

288.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 288. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

288.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 288.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

288.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 288.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

288.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

288.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 288.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 288.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 289: Customer communication (Part 20)

289.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 289. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

289.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 289.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

289.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 289.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

289.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

289.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 289.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 289.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 290: Staff training and certification (Part 20)

290.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 290. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

290.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 290.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

290.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 290.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

290.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

290.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 290.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 290.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 291: Credit appraisal (Part 21)

291.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 291. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

291.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 291.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

291.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 291.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

291.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

291.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 291.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 291.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 292: Income assessment (Part 21)

292.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 292. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

292.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 292.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

292.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 292.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

292.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

292.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 292.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 292.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 293: Property valuation (Part 21)

293.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 293. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

293.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 293.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

293.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 293.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

293.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

293.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 293.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 293.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 294: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 21)

294.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 294. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

294.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 294.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

294.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 294.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

294.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

294.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 294.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 294.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 295: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 21)

295.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 295. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

295.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 295.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

295.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 295.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

295.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

295.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 295.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 295.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 296: Loan documentation (Part 21)

296.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 296. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

296.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 296.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

296.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 296.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

296.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

296.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 296.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 296.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 297: Disbursement conditions (Part 21)

297.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 297. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

297.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 297.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

297.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 297.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

297.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

297.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 297.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 297.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 298: Collections and recovery (Part 21)

298.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 298. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

298.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 298.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

298.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 298.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

298.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

298.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 298.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 298.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 299: Customer grievance handling (Part 21)

299.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 299. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

299.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 299.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

299.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 299.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

299.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

299.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 299.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 299.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 300: Internal audit and compliance (Part 21)

300.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 300. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

300.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 300.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

300.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 300.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

300.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

300.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 300.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 300.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 301: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 21)

301.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 301. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

301.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 301.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

301.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 301.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

301.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

301.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 301.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 301.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 302: Fraud monitoring (Part 21)

302.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 302. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

302.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 302.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

302.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 302.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

302.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

302.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 302.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 302.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 303: Customer communication (Part 21)

303.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 303. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

303.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 303.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

303.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 303.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

303.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

303.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 303.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 303.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 304: Staff training and certification (Part 21)

304.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 304. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

304.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 304.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

304.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 304.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

304.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

304.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 304.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 304.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 305: Credit appraisal (Part 22)

305.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 305. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

305.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 305.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

305.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 305.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

305.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

305.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 305.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 305.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 306: Income assessment (Part 22)

306.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 306. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

306.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 306.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

306.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 306.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

306.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

306.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 306.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 306.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 307: Property valuation (Part 22)

307.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 307. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

307.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 307.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

307.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 307.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

307.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

307.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 307.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 307.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 308: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 22)

308.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 308. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

308.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 308.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

308.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 308.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

308.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

308.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 308.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 308.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 309: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 22)

309.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 309. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

309.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 309.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

309.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 309.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

309.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

309.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 309.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 309.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 310: Loan documentation (Part 22)

310.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 310. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

310.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 310.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

310.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 310.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

310.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

310.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 310.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 310.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 311: Disbursement conditions (Part 22)

311.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 311. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

311.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 311.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

311.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 311.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

311.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

311.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 311.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 311.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 312: Collections and recovery (Part 22)

312.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 312. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

312.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 312.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

312.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 312.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

312.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

312.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 312.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 312.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 313: Customer grievance handling (Part 22)

313.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 313. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

313.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 313.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

313.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 313.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

313.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

313.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 313.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 313.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 314: Internal audit and compliance (Part 22)

314.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 314. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

314.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 314.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

314.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 314.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

314.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

314.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 314.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 314.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 315: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 22)

315.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 315. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

315.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 315.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

315.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 315.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

315.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

315.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 315.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 315.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 316: Fraud monitoring (Part 22)

316.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 316. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

316.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 316.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

316.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 316.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

316.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

316.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 316.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 316.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 317: Customer communication (Part 22)

317.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 317. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

317.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 317.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

317.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 317.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

317.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

317.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 317.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 317.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 318: Staff training and certification (Part 22)

318.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 318. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

318.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 318.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

318.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 318.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

318.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

318.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 318.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 318.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 319: Credit appraisal (Part 23)

319.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 319. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

319.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 319.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

319.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 319.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

319.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

319.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 319.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 319.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 320: Income assessment (Part 23)

320.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 320. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

320.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 320.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

320.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 320.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

320.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

320.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 320.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 320.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 321: Property valuation (Part 23)

321.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 321. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

321.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 321.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

321.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 321.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

321.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

321.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 321.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 321.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 322: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 23)

322.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 322. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

322.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 322.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

322.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 322.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

322.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

322.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 322.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 322.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 323: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 23)

323.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 323. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

323.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 323.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

323.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 323.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

323.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

323.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 323.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 323.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 324: Loan documentation (Part 23)

324.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 324. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

324.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 324.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

324.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 324.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

324.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

324.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 324.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 324.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 325: Disbursement conditions (Part 23)

325.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 325. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

325.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 325.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

325.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 325.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

325.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

325.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 325.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 325.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 326: Collections and recovery (Part 23)

326.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 326. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

326.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 326.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

326.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 326.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

326.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

326.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 326.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 326.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 327: Customer grievance handling (Part 23)

327.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 327. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

327.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 327.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

327.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 327.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

327.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

327.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 327.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 327.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 328: Internal audit and compliance (Part 23)

328.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 328. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

328.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 328.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

328.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 328.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

328.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

328.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 328.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 328.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 329: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 23)

329.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 329. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

329.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 329.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

329.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 329.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

329.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

329.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 329.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 329.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 330: Fraud monitoring (Part 23)

330.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 330. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

330.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 330.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

330.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 330.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

330.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

330.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 330.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 330.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 331: Customer communication (Part 23)

331.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 331. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

331.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 331.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

331.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 331.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

331.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

331.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 331.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 331.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 332: Staff training and certification (Part 23)

332.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 332. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

332.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 332.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

332.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 332.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

332.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

332.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 332.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 332.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 333: Credit appraisal (Part 24)

333.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 333. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

333.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 333.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

333.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 333.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

333.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

333.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 333.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 333.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 334: Income assessment (Part 24)

334.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 334. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

334.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 334.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

334.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 334.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

334.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

334.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 334.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 334.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 335: Property valuation (Part 24)

335.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 335. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

335.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 335.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

335.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 335.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

335.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

335.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 335.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 335.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 336: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 24)

336.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 336. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

336.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 336.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

336.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 336.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

336.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

336.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 336.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 336.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 337: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 24)

337.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 337. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

337.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 337.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

337.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 337.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

337.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

337.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 337.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 337.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 338: Loan documentation (Part 24)

338.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 338. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

338.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 338.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

338.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 338.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

338.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

338.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 338.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 338.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 339: Disbursement conditions (Part 24)

339.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 339. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

339.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 339.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

339.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 339.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

339.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

339.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 339.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 339.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 340: Collections and recovery (Part 24)

340.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 340. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

340.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 340.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

340.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 340.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

340.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

340.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 340.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 340.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 341: Customer grievance handling (Part 24)

341.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 341. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

341.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 341.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

341.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 341.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

341.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

341.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 341.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 341.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 342: Internal audit and compliance (Part 24)

342.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 342. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

342.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 342.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

342.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 342.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

342.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

342.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 342.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 342.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 343: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 24)

343.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 343. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

343.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 343.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

343.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 343.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

343.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

343.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 343.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 343.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 344: Fraud monitoring (Part 24)

344.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 344. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

344.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 344.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

344.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 344.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

344.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

344.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 344.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 344.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 345: Customer communication (Part 24)

345.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 345. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

345.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 345.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

345.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 345.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

345.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

345.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 345.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 345.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 346: Staff training and certification (Part 24)

346.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 346. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

346.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 346.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

346.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 346.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

346.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

346.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 346.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 346.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 347: Credit appraisal (Part 25)

347.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 347. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

347.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 347.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

347.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 347.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

347.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

347.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 347.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 347.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 348: Income assessment (Part 25)

348.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 348. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

348.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 348.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

348.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 348.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

348.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

348.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 348.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 348.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 349: Property valuation (Part 25)

349.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 349. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

349.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 349.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

349.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 349.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

349.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

349.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 349.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 349.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 350: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 25)

350.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 350. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

350.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 350.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

350.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 350.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

350.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

350.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 350.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 350.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 351: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 25)

351.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 351. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

351.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 351.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

351.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 351.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

351.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

351.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 351.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 351.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 352: Loan documentation (Part 25)

352.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 352. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

352.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 352.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

352.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 352.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

352.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

352.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 352.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 352.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 353: Disbursement conditions (Part 25)

353.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 353. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

353.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 353.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

353.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 353.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

353.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

353.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 353.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 353.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 354: Collections and recovery (Part 25)

354.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 354. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

354.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 354.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

354.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 354.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

354.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

354.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 354.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 354.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 355: Customer grievance handling (Part 25)

355.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 355. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

355.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 355.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

355.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 355.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

355.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

355.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 355.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 355.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 356: Internal audit and compliance (Part 25)

356.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 356. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

356.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 356.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

356.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 356.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

356.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

356.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 356.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 356.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 357: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 25)

357.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 357. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

357.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 357.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

357.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 357.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

357.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

357.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 357.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 357.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 358: Fraud monitoring (Part 25)

358.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 358. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

358.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 358.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

358.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 358.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

358.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

358.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 358.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 358.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 359: Customer communication (Part 25)

359.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 359. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

359.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 359.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

359.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 359.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

359.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

359.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 359.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 359.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 360: Staff training and certification (Part 25)

360.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 360. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

360.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 360.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

360.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 360.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

360.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

360.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 360.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 360.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 361: Credit appraisal (Part 26)

361.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 361. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

361.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 361.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

361.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 361.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

361.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

361.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 361.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 361.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 362: Income assessment (Part 26)

362.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 362. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

362.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 362.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

362.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 362.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

362.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

362.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 362.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 362.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 363: Property valuation (Part 26)

363.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 363. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

363.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 363.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

363.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 363.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

363.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

363.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 363.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 363.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 364: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 26)

364.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 364. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

364.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 364.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

364.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 364.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

364.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

364.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 364.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 364.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 365: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 26)

365.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 365. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

365.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 365.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

365.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 365.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

365.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

365.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 365.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 365.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 366: Loan documentation (Part 26)

366.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 366. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

366.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 366.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

366.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 366.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

366.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

366.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 366.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 366.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 367: Disbursement conditions (Part 26)

367.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 367. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

367.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 367.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

367.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 367.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

367.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

367.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 367.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 367.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 368: Collections and recovery (Part 26)

368.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 368. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

368.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 368.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

368.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 368.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

368.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

368.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 368.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 368.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 369: Customer grievance handling (Part 26)

369.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 369. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

369.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 369.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

369.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 369.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

369.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

369.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 369.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 369.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 370: Internal audit and compliance (Part 26)

370.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 370. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

370.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 370.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

370.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 370.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

370.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

370.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 370.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 370.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 371: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 26)

371.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 371. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

371.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 371.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

371.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 371.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

371.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

371.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 371.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 371.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 372: Fraud monitoring (Part 26)

372.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 372. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

372.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 372.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

372.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 372.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

372.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

372.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 372.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 372.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 373: Customer communication (Part 26)

373.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 373. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

373.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 373.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

373.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 373.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

373.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

373.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 373.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 373.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 374: Staff training and certification (Part 26)

374.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 374. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

374.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 374.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

374.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 374.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

374.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

374.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 374.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 374.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 375: Credit appraisal (Part 27)

375.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 375. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

375.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 375.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

375.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 375.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

375.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

375.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 375.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 375.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 376: Income assessment (Part 27)

376.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 376. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

376.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 376.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

376.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 376.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

376.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

376.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 376.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 376.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 377: Property valuation (Part 27)

377.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 377. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

377.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 377.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

377.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 377.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

377.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

377.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 377.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 377.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 378: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 27)

378.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 378. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

378.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 378.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

378.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 378.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

378.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

378.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 378.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 378.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 379: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 27)

379.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 379. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

379.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 379.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

379.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 379.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

379.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

379.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 379.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 379.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 380: Loan documentation (Part 27)

380.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 380. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

380.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 380.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

380.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 380.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

380.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

380.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 380.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 380.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 381: Disbursement conditions (Part 27)

381.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 381. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

381.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 381.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

381.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 381.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

381.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

381.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 381.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 381.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 382: Collections and recovery (Part 27)

382.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 382. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

382.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 382.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

382.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 382.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

382.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

382.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 382.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 382.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 383: Customer grievance handling (Part 27)

383.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 383. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

383.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 383.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

383.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 383.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

383.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

383.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 383.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 383.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 384: Internal audit and compliance (Part 27)

384.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 384. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

384.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 384.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

384.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 384.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

384.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

384.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 384.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 384.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 385: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 27)

385.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 385. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

385.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 385.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

385.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 385.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

385.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

385.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 385.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 385.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 386: Fraud monitoring (Part 27)

386.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 386. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

386.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 386.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

386.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 386.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

386.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

386.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 386.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 386.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 387: Customer communication (Part 27)

387.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 387. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

387.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 387.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

387.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 387.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

387.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

387.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 387.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 387.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 388: Staff training and certification (Part 27)

388.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 388. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

388.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 388.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

388.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 388.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

388.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

388.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 388.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 388.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 389: Credit appraisal (Part 28)

389.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 389. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

389.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 389.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

389.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 389.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

389.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

389.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 389.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 389.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 390: Income assessment (Part 28)

390.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 390. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

390.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 390.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

390.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 390.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

390.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

390.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 390.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 390.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 391: Property valuation (Part 28)

391.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 391. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

391.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 391.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

391.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 391.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

391.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

391.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 391.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 391.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 392: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 28)

392.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 392. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

392.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 392.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

392.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 392.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

392.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

392.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 392.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 392.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 393: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 28)

393.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 393. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

393.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 393.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

393.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 393.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

393.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

393.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 393.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 393.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 394: Loan documentation (Part 28)

394.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 394. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

394.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 394.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

394.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 394.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

394.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

394.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 394.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 394.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 395: Disbursement conditions (Part 28)

395.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 395. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

395.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 395.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

395.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 395.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

395.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

395.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 395.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 395.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 396: Collections and recovery (Part 28)

396.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 396. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

396.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 396.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

396.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 396.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

396.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

396.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 396.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 396.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 397: Customer grievance handling (Part 28)

397.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 397. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

397.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 397.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

397.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 397.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

397.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

397.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 397.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 397.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 398: Internal audit and compliance (Part 28)

398.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 398. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

398.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 398.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

398.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 398.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

398.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

398.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 398.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 398.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 399: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 28)

399.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 399. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

399.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 399.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

399.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 399.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

399.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

399.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 399.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 399.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 400: Fraud monitoring (Part 28)

400.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 400. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

400.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 400.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

400.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 400.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

400.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

400.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 400.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 400.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 401: Customer communication (Part 28)

401.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 401. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

401.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 401.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

401.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 401.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

401.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

401.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 401.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 401.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 402: Staff training and certification (Part 28)

402.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 402. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

402.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 402.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

402.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 402.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

402.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

402.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 402.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 402.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 403: Credit appraisal (Part 29)

403.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 403. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

403.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 403.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

403.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 403.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

403.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

403.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 403.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 403.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 404: Income assessment (Part 29)

404.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 404. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

404.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 404.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

404.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 404.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

404.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

404.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 404.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 404.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 405: Property valuation (Part 29)

405.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 405. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

405.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 405.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

405.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 405.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

405.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

405.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 405.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 405.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 406: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 29)

406.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 406. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

406.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 406.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

406.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 406.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

406.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

406.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 406.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 406.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 407: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 29)

407.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 407. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

407.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 407.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

407.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 407.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

407.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

407.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 407.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 407.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 408: Loan documentation (Part 29)

408.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 408. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

408.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 408.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

408.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 408.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

408.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

408.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 408.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 408.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 409: Disbursement conditions (Part 29)

409.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 409. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

409.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 409.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

409.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 409.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

409.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

409.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 409.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 409.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 410: Collections and recovery (Part 29)

410.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 410. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

410.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 410.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

410.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 410.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

410.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

410.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 410.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 410.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 411: Customer grievance handling (Part 29)

411.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 411. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

411.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 411.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

411.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 411.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

411.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

411.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 411.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 411.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 412: Internal audit and compliance (Part 29)

412.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 412. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

412.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 412.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

412.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 412.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

412.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

412.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 412.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 412.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 413: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 29)

413.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 413. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

413.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 413.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

413.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 413.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

413.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

413.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 413.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 413.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 414: Fraud monitoring (Part 29)

414.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 414. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

414.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 414.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

414.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 414.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

414.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

414.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 414.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 414.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 415: Customer communication (Part 29)

415.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 415. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

415.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 415.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

415.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 415.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

415.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

415.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 415.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 415.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 416: Staff training and certification (Part 29)

416.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 416. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

416.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 416.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

416.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 416.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

416.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

416.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 416.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 416.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 417: Credit appraisal (Part 30)

417.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 417. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

417.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 417.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

417.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 417.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

417.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

417.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 417.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 417.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 418: Income assessment (Part 30)

418.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 418. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

418.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 418.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

418.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 418.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

418.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

418.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 418.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 418.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 419: Property valuation (Part 30)

419.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 419. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

419.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 419.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

419.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 419.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

419.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

419.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 419.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 419.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 420: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 30)

420.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 420. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

420.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 420.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

420.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 420.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

420.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

420.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 420.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 420.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 421: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 30)

421.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 421. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

421.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 421.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

421.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 421.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

421.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

421.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 421.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 421.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 422: Loan documentation (Part 30)

422.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 422. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

422.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 422.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

422.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 422.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

422.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

422.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 422.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 422.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 423: Disbursement conditions (Part 30)

423.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 423. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

423.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 423.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

423.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 423.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

423.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

423.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 423.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 423.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 424: Collections and recovery (Part 30)

424.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 424. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

424.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 424.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

424.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 424.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

424.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

424.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 424.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 424.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 425: Customer grievance handling (Part 30)

425.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 425. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

425.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 425.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

425.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 425.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

425.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

425.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 425.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 425.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 426: Internal audit and compliance (Part 30)

426.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 426. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

426.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 426.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

426.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 426.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

426.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

426.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 426.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 426.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 427: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 30)

427.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 427. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

427.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 427.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

427.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 427.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

427.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

427.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 427.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 427.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 428: Fraud monitoring (Part 30)

428.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 428. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

428.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 428.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

428.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 428.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

428.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

428.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 428.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 428.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 429: Customer communication (Part 30)

429.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 429. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

429.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 429.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

429.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 429.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

429.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

429.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 429.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 429.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 430: Staff training and certification (Part 30)

430.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 430. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

430.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 430.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

430.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 430.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

430.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

430.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 430.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 430.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 431: Credit appraisal (Part 31)

431.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 431. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

431.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 431.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

431.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 431.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

431.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

431.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 431.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 431.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 432: Income assessment (Part 31)

432.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 432. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

432.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 432.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

432.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 432.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

432.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

432.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 432.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 432.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 433: Property valuation (Part 31)

433.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 433. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

433.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 433.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

433.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 433.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

433.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

433.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 433.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 433.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 434: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 31)

434.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 434. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

434.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 434.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

434.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 434.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

434.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

434.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 434.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 434.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 435: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 31)

435.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 435. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

435.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 435.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

435.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 435.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

435.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

435.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 435.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 435.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 436: Loan documentation (Part 31)

436.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 436. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

436.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 436.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

436.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 436.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

436.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

436.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 436.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 436.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 437: Disbursement conditions (Part 31)

437.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 437. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

437.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 437.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

437.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 437.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

437.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

437.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 437.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 437.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 438: Collections and recovery (Part 31)

438.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 438. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

438.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 438.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

438.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 438.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

438.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

438.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 438.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 438.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 439: Customer grievance handling (Part 31)

439.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 439. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

439.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 439.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

439.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 439.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

439.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

439.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 439.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 439.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 440: Internal audit and compliance (Part 31)

440.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 440. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

440.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 440.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

440.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 440.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

440.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

440.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 440.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 440.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 441: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 31)

441.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 441. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

441.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 441.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

441.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 441.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

441.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

441.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 441.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 441.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 442: Fraud monitoring (Part 31)

442.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 442. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

442.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 442.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

442.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 442.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

442.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

442.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 442.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 442.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 443: Customer communication (Part 31)

443.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 443. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

443.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 443.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

443.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 443.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

443.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

443.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 443.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 443.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 444: Staff training and certification (Part 31)

444.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 444. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

444.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 444.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

444.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 444.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

444.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

444.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 444.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 444.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 445: Credit appraisal (Part 32)

445.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 445. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

445.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 445.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

445.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 445.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

445.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

445.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 445.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 445.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 446: Income assessment (Part 32)

446.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 446. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

446.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 446.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

446.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 446.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

446.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

446.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 446.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 446.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 447: Property valuation (Part 32)

447.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 447. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

447.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 447.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

447.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 447.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

447.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

447.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 447.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 447.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 448: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 32)

448.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 448. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

448.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 448.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

448.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 448.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

448.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

448.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 448.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 448.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 449: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 32)

449.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 449. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

449.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 449.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

449.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 449.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

449.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

449.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 449.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 449.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 450: Loan documentation (Part 32)

450.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 450. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

450.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 450.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

450.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 450.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

450.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

450.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 450.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 450.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 451: Disbursement conditions (Part 32)

451.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 451. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

451.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 451.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

451.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 451.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

451.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

451.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 451.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 451.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 452: Collections and recovery (Part 32)

452.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 452. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

452.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 452.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

452.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 452.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

452.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

452.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 452.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 452.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 453: Customer grievance handling (Part 32)

453.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 453. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

453.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 453.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

453.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 453.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

453.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

453.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 453.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 453.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 454: Internal audit and compliance (Part 32)

454.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 454. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

454.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 454.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

454.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 454.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

454.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

454.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 454.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 454.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 455: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 32)

455.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 455. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

455.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 455.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

455.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 455.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

455.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

455.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 455.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 455.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 456: Fraud monitoring (Part 32)

456.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 456. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

456.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 456.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

456.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 456.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

456.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

456.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 456.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 456.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 457: Customer communication (Part 32)

457.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 457. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

457.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 457.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

457.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 457.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

457.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

457.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 457.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 457.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 458: Staff training and certification (Part 32)

458.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 458. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

458.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 458.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

458.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 458.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

458.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

458.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 458.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 458.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 459: Credit appraisal (Part 33)

459.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 459. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

459.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 459.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

459.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 459.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

459.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

459.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 459.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 459.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 460: Income assessment (Part 33)

460.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 460. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

460.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 460.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

460.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 460.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

460.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

460.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 460.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 460.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 461: Property valuation (Part 33)

461.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 461. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

461.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 461.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

461.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 461.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

461.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

461.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 461.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 461.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 462: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 33)

462.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 462. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

462.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 462.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

462.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 462.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

462.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

462.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 462.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 462.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 463: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 33)

463.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 463. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

463.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 463.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

463.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 463.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

463.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

463.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 463.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 463.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 464: Loan documentation (Part 33)

464.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 464. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

464.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 464.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

464.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 464.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

464.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

464.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 464.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 464.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 465: Disbursement conditions (Part 33)

465.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 465. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

465.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 465.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

465.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 465.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

465.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

465.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 465.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 465.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 466: Collections and recovery (Part 33)

466.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 466. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

466.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 466.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

466.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 466.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

466.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

466.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 466.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 466.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 467: Customer grievance handling (Part 33)

467.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 467. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

467.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 467.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

467.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 467.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

467.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

467.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 467.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 467.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 468: Internal audit and compliance (Part 33)

468.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 468. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

468.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 468.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

468.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 468.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

468.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

468.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 468.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 468.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 469: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 33)

469.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 469. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

469.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 469.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

469.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 469.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

469.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

469.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 469.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 469.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 470: Fraud monitoring (Part 33)

470.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 470. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

470.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 470.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

470.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 470.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

470.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

470.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 470.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 470.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 471: Customer communication (Part 33)

471.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 471. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

471.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 471.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

471.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 471.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

471.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

471.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 471.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 471.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 472: Staff training and certification (Part 33)

472.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 472. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

472.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 472.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

472.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 472.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

472.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

472.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 472.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 472.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 473: Credit appraisal (Part 34)

473.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 473. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

473.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 473.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

473.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 473.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

473.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

473.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 473.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 473.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 474: Income assessment (Part 34)

474.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 474. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

474.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 474.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

474.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 474.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

474.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

474.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 474.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 474.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 475: Property valuation (Part 34)

475.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 475. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

475.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 475.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

475.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 475.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

475.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

475.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 475.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 475.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 476: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 34)

476.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 476. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

476.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 476.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

476.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 476.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

476.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

476.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 476.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 476.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 477: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 34)

477.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 477. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

477.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 477.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

477.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 477.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

477.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

477.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 477.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 477.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 478: Loan documentation (Part 34)

478.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 478. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

478.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 478.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

478.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 478.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

478.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

478.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 478.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 478.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 479: Disbursement conditions (Part 34)

479.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 479. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

479.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 479.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

479.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 479.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

479.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

479.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 479.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 479.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 480: Collections and recovery (Part 34)

480.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 480. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

480.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 480.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

480.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 480.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

480.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

480.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 480.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 480.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 481: Customer grievance handling (Part 34)

481.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 481. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

481.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 481.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

481.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 481.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

481.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

481.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 481.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 481.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 482: Internal audit and compliance (Part 34)

482.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 482. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

482.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 482.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

482.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 482.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

482.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

482.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 482.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 482.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 483: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 34)

483.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 483. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

483.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 483.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

483.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 483.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

483.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

483.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 483.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 483.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 484: Fraud monitoring (Part 34)

484.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 484. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

484.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 484.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

484.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 484.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

484.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

484.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 484.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 484.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 485: Customer communication (Part 34)

485.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 485. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

485.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 485.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

485.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 485.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

485.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

485.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 485.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 485.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 486: Staff training and certification (Part 34)

486.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 486. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

486.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 486.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

486.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 486.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

486.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

486.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 486.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 486.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 487: Credit appraisal (Part 35)

487.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 487. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

487.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 487.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

487.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 487.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

487.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

487.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 487.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 487.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 488: Income assessment (Part 35)

488.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 488. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

488.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 488.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

488.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 488.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

488.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

488.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 488.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 488.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 489: Property valuation (Part 35)

489.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 489. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

489.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 489.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

489.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 489.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

489.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

489.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 489.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 489.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 490: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 35)

490.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 490. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

490.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 490.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

490.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 490.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

490.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

490.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 490.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 490.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 491: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 35)

491.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 491. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

491.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 491.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

491.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 491.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

491.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

491.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 491.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 491.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 492: Loan documentation (Part 35)

492.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 492. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

492.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 492.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

492.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 492.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

492.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

492.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 492.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 492.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 493: Disbursement conditions (Part 35)

493.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 493. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

493.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 493.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

493.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 493.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

493.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

493.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 493.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 493.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 494: Collections and recovery (Part 35)

494.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 494. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

494.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 494.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

494.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 494.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

494.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

494.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 494.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 494.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 495: Customer grievance handling (Part 35)

495.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 495. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

495.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 495.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

495.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 495.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

495.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

495.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 495.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 495.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Annexure A - Branch Master

The table below lists the branches authorised to originate mortgage loans under this version of the Policy, with the grade of each branch. The grade decides the sanction limit in clause 9.1.

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0001	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0002	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0003	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0004	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0005	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0006	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0007	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0008	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0009	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0010	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0011	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0012	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0013	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0014	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0015	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0016	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0017	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0018	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0019	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0020	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0021	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0022	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0023	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0024	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0025	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0026	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0027	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0028	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0029	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0030	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0031	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0032	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0033	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0034	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0035	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0036	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0037	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0038	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0039	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0040	Delhi	North	Grade B

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0041	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0042	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0043	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0044	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0045	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0046	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0047	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0048	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0049	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0050	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0051	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0052	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0053	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0054	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0055	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0056	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0057	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0058	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0059	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0060	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0061	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0062	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0063	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0064	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0065	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0066	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0067	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0068	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0069	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0070	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0071	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0072	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0073	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0074	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0075	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0076	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0077	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0078	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0079	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0080	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0081	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0082	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0083	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0084	Surat	West	Grade A

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0085	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0086	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0087	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0088	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0089	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0090	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0091	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0092	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0093	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0094	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0095	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0096	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0097	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0098	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0099	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0100	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0101	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0102	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0103	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0104	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0105	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0106	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0107	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0108	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0109	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0110	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0111	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0112	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0113	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0114	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0115	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0116	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0117	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0118	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0119	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0120	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0121	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0122	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0123	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0124	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0125	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0126	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0127	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0128	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0129	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0130	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0131	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0132	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0133	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0134	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0135	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0136	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0137	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0138	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0139	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0140	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0141	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0142	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0143	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0144	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0145	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0146	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0147	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0148	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0149	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0150	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0151	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0152	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0153	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0154	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0155	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0156	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0157	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0158	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0159	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0160	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0161	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0162	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0163	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0164	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0165	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0166	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0167	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0168	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0169	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0170	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0171	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0172	Delhi	North	Grade B

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0173	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0174	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0175	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0176	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0177	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0178	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0179	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0180	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0181	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0182	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0183	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0184	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0185	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0186	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0187	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0188	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0189	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0190	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0191	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0192	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0193	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0194	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0195	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0196	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0197	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0198	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0199	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0200	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0201	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0202	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0203	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0204	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0205	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0206	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0207	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0208	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0209	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0210	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0211	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0212	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0213	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0214	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0215	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0216	Surat	West	Grade A

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0217	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0218	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0219	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0220	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0221	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0222	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0223	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0224	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0225	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0226	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0227	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0228	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0229	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0230	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0231	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0232	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0233	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0234	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0235	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0236	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0237	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0238	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0239	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0240	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0241	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0242	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0243	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0244	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0245	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0246	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0247	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0248	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0249	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0250	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0251	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0252	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0253	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0254	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0255	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0256	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0257	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0258	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0259	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0260	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0261	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0262	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0263	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0264	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0265	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0266	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0267	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0268	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0269	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0270	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0271	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0272	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0273	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0274	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0275	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0276	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0277	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0278	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0279	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0280	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0281	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0282	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0283	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0284	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0285	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0286	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0287	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0288	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0289	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0290	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0291	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0292	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0293	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0294	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0295	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0296	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0297	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0298	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0299	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0300	Surat	West	Grade A

Annexure B - Document Retention Register

The table below sets the period for which each class of document is retained after the loan is closed.

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00001	Title search report (series 1)	8 years
DC-00002	Sanction letter (series 2)	5 years
DC-00003	KYC pack (series 3)	10 years
DC-00004	Valuation report (series 4)	7 years
DC-00005	Legal opinion (series 5)	4 years
DC-00006	Insurance certificate (series 6)	9 years
DC-00007	Disbursement memo (series 7)	6 years
DC-00008	Sale deed copy (series 8)	3 years
DC-00009	Title search report (series 9)	8 years
DC-00010	Sanction letter (series 10)	5 years
DC-00011	KYC pack (series 11)	10 years
DC-00012	Valuation report (series 12)	7 years
DC-00013	Legal opinion (series 13)	4 years
DC-00014	Insurance certificate (series 14)	9 years
DC-00015	Disbursement memo (series 15)	6 years
DC-00016	Sale deed copy (series 16)	3 years
DC-00017	Title search report (series 17)	8 years
DC-00018	Sanction letter (series 18)	5 years
DC-00019	KYC pack (series 19)	10 years
DC-00020	Valuation report (series 20)	7 years
DC-00021	Legal opinion (series 21)	4 years
DC-00022	Insurance certificate (series 22)	9 years
DC-00023	Disbursement memo (series 23)	6 years
DC-00024	Sale deed copy (series 24)	3 years
DC-00025	Title search report (series 25)	8 years
DC-00026	Sanction letter (series 26)	5 years
DC-00027	KYC pack (series 27)	10 years
DC-00028	Valuation report (series 28)	7 years
DC-00029	Legal opinion (series 29)	4 years
DC-00030	Insurance certificate (series 30)	9 years
DC-00031	Disbursement memo (series 31)	6 years
DC-00032	Sale deed copy (series 32)	3 years
DC-00033	Title search report (series 33)	8 years
DC-00034	Sanction letter (series 34)	5 years
DC-00035	KYC pack (series 35)	10 years
DC-00036	Valuation report (series 36)	7 years
DC-00037	Legal opinion (series 37)	4 years
DC-00038	Insurance certificate (series 38)	9 years
DC-00039	Disbursement memo (series 39)	6 years
DC-00040	Sale deed copy (series 40)	3 years
DC-00041	Title search report (series 41)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00042	Sanction letter (series 42)	5 years
DC-00043	KYC pack (series 43)	10 years
DC-00044	Valuation report (series 44)	7 years
DC-00045	Legal opinion (series 45)	4 years
DC-00046	Insurance certificate (series 46)	9 years
DC-00047	Disbursement memo (series 47)	6 years
DC-00048	Sale deed copy (series 48)	3 years
DC-00049	Title search report (series 49)	8 years
DC-00050	Sanction letter (series 50)	5 years
DC-00051	KYC pack (series 51)	10 years
DC-00052	Valuation report (series 52)	7 years
DC-00053	Legal opinion (series 53)	4 years
DC-00054	Insurance certificate (series 54)	9 years
DC-00055	Disbursement memo (series 55)	6 years
DC-00056	Sale deed copy (series 56)	3 years
DC-00057	Title search report (series 57)	8 years
DC-00058	Sanction letter (series 58)	5 years
DC-00059	KYC pack (series 59)	10 years
DC-00060	Valuation report (series 60)	7 years
DC-00061	Legal opinion (series 61)	4 years
DC-00062	Insurance certificate (series 62)	9 years
DC-00063	Disbursement memo (series 63)	6 years
DC-00064	Sale deed copy (series 64)	3 years
DC-00065	Title search report (series 65)	8 years
DC-00066	Sanction letter (series 66)	5 years
DC-00067	KYC pack (series 67)	10 years
DC-00068	Valuation report (series 68)	7 years
DC-00069	Legal opinion (series 69)	4 years
DC-00070	Insurance certificate (series 70)	9 years
DC-00071	Disbursement memo (series 71)	6 years
DC-00072	Sale deed copy (series 72)	3 years
DC-00073	Title search report (series 73)	8 years
DC-00074	Sanction letter (series 74)	5 years
DC-00075	KYC pack (series 75)	10 years
DC-00076	Valuation report (series 76)	7 years
DC-00077	Legal opinion (series 77)	4 years
DC-00078	Insurance certificate (series 78)	9 years
DC-00079	Disbursement memo (series 79)	6 years
DC-00080	Sale deed copy (series 80)	3 years
DC-00081	Title search report (series 81)	8 years
DC-00082	Sanction letter (series 82)	5 years
DC-00083	KYC pack (series 83)	10 years
DC-00084	Valuation report (series 84)	7 years
DC-00085	Legal opinion (series 85)	4 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00086	Insurance certificate (series 86)	9 years
DC-00087	Disbursement memo (series 87)	6 years
DC-00088	Sale deed copy (series 88)	3 years
DC-00089	Title search report (series 89)	8 years
DC-00090	Sanction letter (series 90)	5 years
DC-00091	KYC pack (series 91)	10 years
DC-00092	Valuation report (series 92)	7 years
DC-00093	Legal opinion (series 93)	4 years
DC-00094	Insurance certificate (series 94)	9 years
DC-00095	Disbursement memo (series 95)	6 years
DC-00096	Sale deed copy (series 96)	3 years
DC-00097	Title search report (series 97)	8 years
DC-00098	Sanction letter (series 98)	5 years
DC-00099	KYC pack (series 99)	10 years
DC-00100	Valuation report (series 100)	7 years
DC-00101	Legal opinion (series 101)	4 years
DC-00102	Insurance certificate (series 102)	9 years
DC-00103	Disbursement memo (series 103)	6 years
DC-00104	Sale deed copy (series 104)	3 years
DC-00105	Title search report (series 105)	8 years
DC-00106	Sanction letter (series 106)	5 years
DC-00107	KYC pack (series 107)	10 years
DC-00108	Valuation report (series 108)	7 years
DC-00109	Legal opinion (series 109)	4 years
DC-00110	Insurance certificate (series 110)	9 years
DC-00111	Disbursement memo (series 111)	6 years
DC-00112	Sale deed copy (series 112)	3 years
DC-00113	Title search report (series 113)	8 years
DC-00114	Sanction letter (series 114)	5 years
DC-00115	KYC pack (series 115)	10 years
DC-00116	Valuation report (series 116)	7 years
DC-00117	Legal opinion (series 117)	4 years
DC-00118	Insurance certificate (series 118)	9 years
DC-00119	Disbursement memo (series 119)	6 years
DC-00120	Sale deed copy (series 120)	3 years
DC-00121	Title search report (series 121)	8 years
DC-00122	Sanction letter (series 122)	5 years
DC-00123	KYC pack (series 123)	10 years
DC-00124	Valuation report (series 124)	7 years
DC-00125	Legal opinion (series 125)	4 years
DC-00126	Insurance certificate (series 126)	9 years
DC-00127	Disbursement memo (series 127)	6 years
DC-00128	Sale deed copy (series 128)	3 years
DC-00129	Title search report (series 129)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00130	Sanction letter (series 130)	5 years
DC-00131	KYC pack (series 131)	10 years
DC-00132	Valuation report (series 132)	7 years
DC-00133	Legal opinion (series 133)	4 years
DC-00134	Insurance certificate (series 134)	9 years
DC-00135	Disbursement memo (series 135)	6 years
DC-00136	Sale deed copy (series 136)	3 years
DC-00137	Title search report (series 137)	8 years
DC-00138	Sanction letter (series 138)	5 years
DC-00139	KYC pack (series 139)	10 years
DC-00140	Valuation report (series 140)	7 years
DC-00141	Legal opinion (series 141)	4 years
DC-00142	Insurance certificate (series 142)	9 years
DC-00143	Disbursement memo (series 143)	6 years
DC-00144	Sale deed copy (series 144)	3 years
DC-00145	Title search report (series 145)	8 years
DC-00146	Sanction letter (series 146)	5 years
DC-00147	KYC pack (series 147)	10 years
DC-00148	Valuation report (series 148)	7 years
DC-00149	Legal opinion (series 149)	4 years
DC-00150	Insurance certificate (series 150)	9 years
DC-00151	Disbursement memo (series 151)	6 years
DC-00152	Sale deed copy (series 152)	3 years
DC-00153	Title search report (series 153)	8 years
DC-00154	Sanction letter (series 154)	5 years
DC-00155	KYC pack (series 155)	10 years
DC-00156	Valuation report (series 156)	7 years
DC-00157	Legal opinion (series 157)	4 years
DC-00158	Insurance certificate (series 158)	9 years
DC-00159	Disbursement memo (series 159)	6 years
DC-00160	Sale deed copy (series 160)	3 years
DC-00161	Title search report (series 161)	8 years
DC-00162	Sanction letter (series 162)	5 years
DC-00163	KYC pack (series 163)	10 years
DC-00164	Valuation report (series 164)	7 years
DC-00165	Legal opinion (series 165)	4 years
DC-00166	Insurance certificate (series 166)	9 years
DC-00167	Disbursement memo (series 167)	6 years
DC-00168	Sale deed copy (series 168)	3 years
DC-00169	Title search report (series 169)	8 years
DC-00170	Sanction letter (series 170)	5 years
DC-00171	KYC pack (series 171)	10 years
DC-00172	Valuation report (series 172)	7 years
DC-00173	Legal opinion (series 173)	4 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00174	Insurance certificate (series 174)	9 years
DC-00175	Disbursement memo (series 175)	6 years
DC-00176	Sale deed copy (series 176)	3 years
DC-00177	Title search report (series 177)	8 years
DC-00178	Sanction letter (series 178)	5 years
DC-00179	KYC pack (series 179)	10 years
DC-00180	Valuation report (series 180)	7 years
DC-00181	Legal opinion (series 181)	4 years
DC-00182	Insurance certificate (series 182)	9 years
DC-00183	Disbursement memo (series 183)	6 years
DC-00184	Sale deed copy (series 184)	3 years
DC-00185	Title search report (series 185)	8 years
DC-00186	Sanction letter (series 186)	5 years
DC-00187	KYC pack (series 187)	10 years
DC-00188	Valuation report (series 188)	7 years
DC-00189	Legal opinion (series 189)	4 years
DC-00190	Insurance certificate (series 190)	9 years
DC-00191	Disbursement memo (series 191)	6 years
DC-00192	Sale deed copy (series 192)	3 years
DC-00193	Title search report (series 193)	8 years
DC-00194	Sanction letter (series 194)	5 years
DC-00195	KYC pack (series 195)	10 years
DC-00196	Valuation report (series 196)	7 years
DC-00197	Legal opinion (series 197)	4 years
DC-00198	Insurance certificate (series 198)	9 years
DC-00199	Disbursement memo (series 199)	6 years
DC-00200	Sale deed copy (series 200)	3 years
DC-00201	Title search report (series 201)	8 years
DC-00202	Sanction letter (series 202)	5 years
DC-00203	KYC pack (series 203)	10 years
DC-00204	Valuation report (series 204)	7 years
DC-00205	Legal opinion (series 205)	4 years
DC-00206	Insurance certificate (series 206)	9 years
DC-00207	Disbursement memo (series 207)	6 years
DC-00208	Sale deed copy (series 208)	3 years
DC-00209	Title search report (series 209)	8 years
DC-00210	Sanction letter (series 210)	5 years
DC-00211	KYC pack (series 211)	10 years
DC-00212	Valuation report (series 212)	7 years
DC-00213	Legal opinion (series 213)	4 years
DC-00214	Insurance certificate (series 214)	9 years
DC-00215	Disbursement memo (series 215)	6 years
DC-00216	Sale deed copy (series 216)	3 years
DC-00217	Title search report (series 217)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00218	Sanction letter (series 218)	5 years
DC-00219	KYC pack (series 219)	10 years
DC-00220	Valuation report (series 220)	7 years
DC-00221	Legal opinion (series 221)	4 years
DC-00222	Insurance certificate (series 222)	9 years
DC-00223	Disbursement memo (series 223)	6 years
DC-00224	Sale deed copy (series 224)	3 years
DC-00225	Title search report (series 225)	8 years
DC-00226	Sanction letter (series 226)	5 years
DC-00227	KYC pack (series 227)	10 years
DC-00228	Valuation report (series 228)	7 years
DC-00229	Legal opinion (series 229)	4 years
DC-00230	Insurance certificate (series 230)	9 years
DC-00231	Disbursement memo (series 231)	6 years
DC-00232	Sale deed copy (series 232)	3 years
DC-00233	Title search report (series 233)	8 years
DC-00234	Sanction letter (series 234)	5 years
DC-00235	KYC pack (series 235)	10 years
DC-00236	Valuation report (series 236)	7 years
DC-00237	Legal opinion (series 237)	4 years
DC-00238	Insurance certificate (series 238)	9 years
DC-00239	Disbursement memo (series 239)	6 years
DC-00240	Sale deed copy (series 240)	3 years
DC-00241	Title search report (series 241)	8 years
DC-00242	Sanction letter (series 242)	5 years
DC-00243	KYC pack (series 243)	10 years
DC-00244	Valuation report (series 244)	7 years
DC-00245	Legal opinion (series 245)	4 years
DC-00246	Insurance certificate (series 246)	9 years
DC-00247	Disbursement memo (series 247)	6 years
DC-00248	Sale deed copy (series 248)	3 years
DC-00249	Title search report (series 249)	8 years
DC-00250	Sanction letter (series 250)	5 years
DC-00251	KYC pack (series 251)	10 years
DC-00252	Valuation report (series 252)	7 years
DC-00253	Legal opinion (series 253)	4 years
DC-00254	Insurance certificate (series 254)	9 years
DC-00255	Disbursement memo (series 255)	6 years
DC-00256	Sale deed copy (series 256)	3 years
DC-00257	Title search report (series 257)	8 years
DC-00258	Sanction letter (series 258)	5 years
DC-00259	KYC pack (series 259)	10 years
DC-00260	Valuation report (series 260)	7 years
DC-00261	Legal opinion (series 261)	4 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00262	Insurance certificate (series 262)	9 years
DC-00263	Disbursement memo (series 263)	6 years
DC-00264	Sale deed copy (series 264)	3 years
DC-00265	Title search report (series 265)	8 years
DC-00266	Sanction letter (series 266)	5 years
DC-00267	KYC pack (series 267)	10 years
DC-00268	Valuation report (series 268)	7 years
DC-00269	Legal opinion (series 269)	4 years
DC-00270	Insurance certificate (series 270)	9 years
DC-00271	Disbursement memo (series 271)	6 years
DC-00272	Sale deed copy (series 272)	3 years
DC-00273	Title search report (series 273)	8 years
DC-00274	Sanction letter (series 274)	5 years
DC-00275	KYC pack (series 275)	10 years
DC-00276	Valuation report (series 276)	7 years
DC-00277	Legal opinion (series 277)	4 years
DC-00278	Insurance certificate (series 278)	9 years
DC-00279	Disbursement memo (series 279)	6 years
DC-00280	Sale deed copy (series 280)	3 years
DC-00281	Title search report (series 281)	8 years
DC-00282	Sanction letter (series 282)	5 years
DC-00283	KYC pack (series 283)	10 years
DC-00284	Valuation report (series 284)	7 years
DC-00285	Legal opinion (series 285)	4 years
DC-00286	Insurance certificate (series 286)	9 years
DC-00287	Disbursement memo (series 287)	6 years
DC-00288	Sale deed copy (series 288)	3 years
DC-00289	Title search report (series 289)	8 years
DC-00290	Sanction letter (series 290)	5 years
DC-00291	KYC pack (series 291)	10 years
DC-00292	Valuation report (series 292)	7 years
DC-00293	Legal opinion (series 293)	4 years
DC-00294	Insurance certificate (series 294)	9 years
DC-00295	Disbursement memo (series 295)	6 years
DC-00296	Sale deed copy (series 296)	3 years
DC-00297	Title search report (series 297)	8 years
DC-00298	Sanction letter (series 298)	5 years
DC-00299	KYC pack (series 299)	10 years
DC-00300	Valuation report (series 300)	7 years
DC-00301	Legal opinion (series 301)	4 years
DC-00302	Insurance certificate (series 302)	9 years
DC-00303	Disbursement memo (series 303)	6 years
DC-00304	Sale deed copy (series 304)	3 years
DC-00305	Title search report (series 305)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00306	Sanction letter (series 306)	5 years
DC-00307	KYC pack (series 307)	10 years
DC-00308	Valuation report (series 308)	7 years
DC-00309	Legal opinion (series 309)	4 years
DC-00310	Insurance certificate (series 310)	9 years
DC-00311	Disbursement memo (series 311)	6 years
DC-00312	Sale deed copy (series 312)	3 years
DC-00313	Title search report (series 313)	8 years
DC-00314	Sanction letter (series 314)	5 years
DC-00315	KYC pack (series 315)	10 years
DC-00316	Valuation report (series 316)	7 years
DC-00317	Legal opinion (series 317)	4 years
DC-00318	Insurance certificate (series 318)	9 years
DC-00319	Disbursement memo (series 319)	6 years
DC-00320	Sale deed copy (series 320)	3 years
DC-00321	Title search report (series 321)	8 years
DC-00322	Sanction letter (series 322)	5 years
DC-00323	KYC pack (series 323)	10 years
DC-00324	Valuation report (series 324)	7 years
DC-00325	Legal opinion (series 325)	4 years
DC-00326	Insurance certificate (series 326)	9 years
DC-00327	Disbursement memo (series 327)	6 years
DC-00328	Sale deed copy (series 328)	3 years
DC-00329	Title search report (series 329)	8 years
DC-00330	Sanction letter (series 330)	5 years
DC-00331	KYC pack (series 331)	10 years
DC-00332	Valuation report (series 332)	7 years
DC-00333	Legal opinion (series 333)	4 years
DC-00334	Insurance certificate (series 334)	9 years
DC-00335	Disbursement memo (series 335)	6 years
DC-00336	Sale deed copy (series 336)	3 years
DC-00337	Title search report (series 337)	8 years
DC-00338	Sanction letter (series 338)	5 years
DC-00339	KYC pack (series 339)	10 years
DC-00340	Valuation report (series 340)	7 years
DC-00341	Legal opinion (series 341)	4 years
DC-00342	Insurance certificate (series 342)	9 years
DC-00343	Disbursement memo (series 343)	6 years
DC-00344	Sale deed copy (series 344)	3 years
DC-00345	Title search report (series 345)	8 years
DC-00346	Sanction letter (series 346)	5 years
DC-00347	KYC pack (series 347)	10 years
DC-00348	Valuation report (series 348)	7 years
DC-00349	Legal opinion (series 349)	4 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00350	Insurance certificate (series 350)	9 years
DC-00351	Disbursement memo (series 351)	6 years
DC-00352	Sale deed copy (series 352)	3 years
DC-00353	Title search report (series 353)	8 years
DC-00354	Sanction letter (series 354)	5 years
DC-00355	KYC pack (series 355)	10 years
DC-00356	Valuation report (series 356)	7 years
DC-00357	Legal opinion (series 357)	4 years
DC-00358	Insurance certificate (series 358)	9 years
DC-00359	Disbursement memo (series 359)	6 years
DC-00360	Sale deed copy (series 360)	3 years
DC-00361	Title search report (series 361)	8 years
DC-00362	Sanction letter (series 362)	5 years
DC-00363	KYC pack (series 363)	10 years
DC-00364	Valuation report (series 364)	7 years
DC-00365	Legal opinion (series 365)	4 years
DC-00366	Insurance certificate (series 366)	9 years
DC-00367	Disbursement memo (series 367)	6 years
DC-00368	Sale deed copy (series 368)	3 years
DC-00369	Title search report (series 369)	8 years
DC-00370	Sanction letter (series 370)	5 years
DC-00371	KYC pack (series 371)	10 years
DC-00372	Valuation report (series 372)	7 years
DC-00373	Legal opinion (series 373)	4 years
DC-00374	Insurance certificate (series 374)	9 years
DC-00375	Disbursement memo (series 375)	6 years
DC-00376	Sale deed copy (series 376)	3 years
DC-00377	Title search report (series 377)	8 years
DC-00378	Sanction letter (series 378)	5 years
DC-00379	KYC pack (series 379)	10 years
DC-00380	Valuation report (series 380)	7 years
DC-00381	Legal opinion (series 381)	4 years
DC-00382	Insurance certificate (series 382)	9 years
DC-00383	Disbursement memo (series 383)	6 years
DC-00384	Sale deed copy (series 384)	3 years
DC-00385	Title search report (series 385)	8 years
DC-00386	Sanction letter (series 386)	5 years
DC-00387	KYC pack (series 387)	10 years
DC-00388	Valuation report (series 388)	7 years
DC-00389	Legal opinion (series 389)	4 years
DC-00390	Insurance certificate (series 390)	9 years
DC-00391	Disbursement memo (series 391)	6 years
DC-00392	Sale deed copy (series 392)	3 years
DC-00393	Title search report (series 393)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00394	Sanction letter (series 394)	5 years
DC-00395	KYC pack (series 395)	10 years
DC-00396	Valuation report (series 396)	7 years
DC-00397	Legal opinion (series 397)	4 years
DC-00398	Insurance certificate (series 398)	9 years
DC-00399	Disbursement memo (series 399)	6 years
DC-00400	Sale deed copy (series 400)	3 years
DC-00401	Title search report (series 401)	8 years
DC-00402	Sanction letter (series 402)	5 years
DC-00403	KYC pack (series 403)	10 years
DC-00404	Valuation report (series 404)	7 years
DC-00405	Legal opinion (series 405)	4 years
DC-00406	Insurance certificate (series 406)	9 years
DC-00407	Disbursement memo (series 407)	6 years
DC-00408	Sale deed copy (series 408)	3 years
DC-00409	Title search report (series 409)	8 years
DC-00410	Sanction letter (series 410)	5 years
DC-00411	KYC pack (series 411)	10 years
DC-00412	Valuation report (series 412)	7 years
DC-00413	Legal opinion (series 413)	4 years
DC-00414	Insurance certificate (series 414)	9 years
DC-00415	Disbursement memo (series 415)	6 years
DC-00416	Sale deed copy (series 416)	3 years
DC-00417	Title search report (series 417)	8 years
DC-00418	Sanction letter (series 418)	5 years
DC-00419	KYC pack (series 419)	10 years
DC-00420	Valuation report (series 420)	7 years
DC-00421	Legal opinion (series 421)	4 years
DC-00422	Insurance certificate (series 422)	9 years
DC-00423	Disbursement memo (series 423)	6 years
DC-00424	Sale deed copy (series 424)	3 years
DC-00425	Title search report (series 425)	8 years
DC-00426	Sanction letter (series 426)	5 years
DC-00427	KYC pack (series 427)	10 years
DC-00428	Valuation report (series 428)	7 years
DC-00429	Legal opinion (series 429)	4 years
DC-00430	Insurance certificate (series 430)	9 years
DC-00431	Disbursement memo (series 431)	6 years
DC-00432	Sale deed copy (series 432)	3 years
DC-00433	Title search report (series 433)	8 years
DC-00434	Sanction letter (series 434)	5 years
DC-00435	KYC pack (series 435)	10 years
DC-00436	Valuation report (series 436)	7 years
DC-00437	Legal opinion (series 437)	4 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00438	Insurance certificate (series 438)	9 years
DC-00439	Disbursement memo (series 439)	6 years
DC-00440	Sale deed copy (series 440)	3 years
DC-00441	Title search report (series 441)	8 years
DC-00442	Sanction letter (series 442)	5 years
DC-00443	KYC pack (series 443)	10 years
DC-00444	Valuation report (series 444)	7 years
DC-00445	Legal opinion (series 445)	4 years
DC-00446	Insurance certificate (series 446)	9 years
DC-00447	Disbursement memo (series 447)	6 years
DC-00448	Sale deed copy (series 448)	3 years
DC-00449	Title search report (series 449)	8 years
DC-00450	Sanction letter (series 450)	5 years
DC-00451	KYC pack (series 451)	10 years
DC-00452	Valuation report (series 452)	7 years
DC-00453	Legal opinion (series 453)	4 years
DC-00454	Insurance certificate (series 454)	9 years
DC-00455	Disbursement memo (series 455)	6 years
DC-00456	Sale deed copy (series 456)	3 years
DC-00457	Title search report (series 457)	8 years
DC-00458	Sanction letter (series 458)	5 years
DC-00459	KYC pack (series 459)	10 years
DC-00460	Valuation report (series 460)	7 years
DC-00461	Legal opinion (series 461)	4 years
DC-00462	Insurance certificate (series 462)	9 years
DC-00463	Disbursement memo (series 463)	6 years
DC-00464	Sale deed copy (series 464)	3 years
DC-00465	Title search report (series 465)	8 years
DC-00466	Sanction letter (series 466)	5 years
DC-00467	KYC pack (series 467)	10 years
DC-00468	Valuation report (series 468)	7 years
DC-00469	Legal opinion (series 469)	4 years
DC-00470	Insurance certificate (series 470)	9 years
DC-00471	Disbursement memo (series 471)	6 years
DC-00472	Sale deed copy (series 472)	3 years
DC-00473	Title search report (series 473)	8 years
DC-00474	Sanction letter (series 474)	5 years
DC-00475	KYC pack (series 475)	10 years
DC-00476	Valuation report (series 476)	7 years
DC-00477	Legal opinion (series 477)	4 years
DC-00478	Insurance certificate (series 478)	9 years
DC-00479	Disbursement memo (series 479)	6 years
DC-00480	Sale deed copy (series 480)	3 years
DC-00481	Title search report (series 481)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00482	Sanction letter (series 482)	5 years
DC-00483	KYC pack (series 483)	10 years
DC-00484	Valuation report (series 484)	7 years
DC-00485	Legal opinion (series 485)	4 years
DC-00486	Insurance certificate (series 486)	9 years
DC-00487	Disbursement memo (series 487)	6 years
DC-00488	Sale deed copy (series 488)	3 years
DC-00489	Title search report (series 489)	8 years
DC-00490	Sanction letter (series 490)	5 years
DC-00491	KYC pack (series 491)	10 years
DC-00492	Valuation report (series 492)	7 years
DC-00493	Legal opinion (series 493)	4 years
DC-00494	Insurance certificate (series 494)	9 years
DC-00495	Disbursement memo (series 495)	6 years
DC-00496	Sale deed copy (series 496)	3 years
DC-00497	Title search report (series 497)	8 years
DC-00498	Sanction letter (series 498)	5 years
DC-00499	KYC pack (series 499)	10 years
DC-00500	Valuation report (series 500)	7 years
DC-00501	Legal opinion (series 501)	4 years
DC-00502	Insurance certificate (series 502)	9 years
DC-00503	Disbursement memo (series 503)	6 years
DC-00504	Sale deed copy (series 504)	3 years
DC-00505	Title search report (series 505)	8 years
DC-00506	Sanction letter (series 506)	5 years
DC-00507	KYC pack (series 507)	10 years
DC-00508	Valuation report (series 508)	7 years
DC-00509	Legal opinion (series 509)	4 years
DC-00510	Insurance certificate (series 510)	9 years
DC-00511	Disbursement memo (series 511)	6 years
DC-00512	Sale deed copy (series 512)	3 years
DC-00513	Title search report (series 513)	8 years
DC-00514	Sanction letter (series 514)	5 years
DC-00515	KYC pack (series 515)	10 years
DC-00516	Valuation report (series 516)	7 years
DC-00517	Legal opinion (series 517)	4 years
DC-00518	Insurance certificate (series 518)	9 years
DC-00519	Disbursement memo (series 519)	6 years
DC-00520	Sale deed copy (series 520)	3 years
DC-00521	Title search report (series 521)	8 years
DC-00522	Sanction letter (series 522)	5 years
DC-00523	KYC pack (series 523)	10 years
DC-00524	Valuation report (series 524)	7 years
DC-00525	Legal opinion (series 525)	4 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00526	Insurance certificate (series 526)	9 years
DC-00527	Disbursement memo (series 527)	6 years
DC-00528	Sale deed copy (series 528)	3 years
DC-00529	Title search report (series 529)	8 years
DC-00530	Sanction letter (series 530)	5 years
DC-00531	KYC pack (series 531)	10 years
DC-00532	Valuation report (series 532)	7 years
DC-00533	Legal opinion (series 533)	4 years
DC-00534	Insurance certificate (series 534)	9 years
DC-00535	Disbursement memo (series 535)	6 years
DC-00536	Sale deed copy (series 536)	3 years
DC-00537	Title search report (series 537)	8 years
DC-00538	Sanction letter (series 538)	5 years
DC-00539	KYC pack (series 539)	10 years
DC-00540	Valuation report (series 540)	7 years
DC-00541	Legal opinion (series 541)	4 years
DC-00542	Insurance certificate (series 542)	9 years
DC-00543	Disbursement memo (series 543)	6 years
DC-00544	Sale deed copy (series 544)	3 years
DC-00545	Title search report (series 545)	8 years
DC-00546	Sanction letter (series 546)	5 years
DC-00547	KYC pack (series 547)	10 years
DC-00548	Valuation report (series 548)	7 years
DC-00549	Legal opinion (series 549)	4 years
DC-00550	Insurance certificate (series 550)	9 years
DC-00551	Disbursement memo (series 551)	6 years
DC-00552	Sale deed copy (series 552)	3 years
DC-00553	Title search report (series 553)	8 years
DC-00554	Sanction letter (series 554)	5 years
DC-00555	KYC pack (series 555)	10 years
DC-00556	Valuation report (series 556)	7 years
DC-00557	Legal opinion (series 557)	4 years
DC-00558	Insurance certificate (series 558)	9 years
DC-00559	Disbursement memo (series 559)	6 years
DC-00560	Sale deed copy (series 560)	3 years
DC-00561	Title search report (series 561)	8 years
DC-00562	Sanction letter (series 562)	5 years
DC-00563	KYC pack (series 563)	10 years
DC-00564	Valuation report (series 564)	7 years
DC-00565	Legal opinion (series 565)	4 years
DC-00566	Insurance certificate (series 566)	9 years
DC-00567	Disbursement memo (series 567)	6 years
DC-00568	Sale deed copy (series 568)	3 years
DC-00569	Title search report (series 569)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00570	Sanction letter (series 570)	5 years
DC-00571	KYC pack (series 571)	10 years
DC-00572	Valuation report (series 572)	7 years
DC-00573	Legal opinion (series 573)	4 years
DC-00574	Insurance certificate (series 574)	9 years
DC-00575	Disbursement memo (series 575)	6 years
DC-00576	Sale deed copy (series 576)	3 years
DC-00577	Title search report (series 577)	8 years
DC-00578	Sanction letter (series 578)	5 years
DC-00579	KYC pack (series 579)	10 years
DC-00580	Valuation report (series 580)	7 years
DC-00581	Legal opinion (series 581)	4 years
DC-00582	Insurance certificate (series 582)	9 years
DC-00583	Disbursement memo (series 583)	6 years
DC-00584	Sale deed copy (series 584)	3 years
DC-00585	Title search report (series 585)	8 years
DC-00586	Sanction letter (series 586)	5 years
DC-00587	KYC pack (series 587)	10 years
DC-00588	Valuation report (series 588)	7 years
DC-00589	Legal opinion (series 589)	4 years
DC-00590	Insurance certificate (series 590)	9 years
DC-00591	Disbursement memo (series 591)	6 years
DC-00592	Sale deed copy (series 592)	3 years
DC-00593	Title search report (series 593)	8 years
DC-00594	Sanction letter (series 594)	5 years
DC-00595	KYC pack (series 595)	10 years
DC-00596	Valuation report (series 596)	7 years
DC-00597	Legal opinion (series 597)	4 years
DC-00598	Insurance certificate (series 598)	9 years
DC-00599	Disbursement memo (series 599)	6 years
DC-00600	Sale deed copy (series 600)	3 years

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End of Document - Mortgage Loan Policy v7.0